

1 ATHLETE - 5 STRENGTHS

Building The Ultimate Athlete



Mental Strength Training Manual

-
- I. MUSCLE STRENGTH
 - II. SPEED STRENGTH
 - III. ANAEROBIC STRENGTH
 - IV. AEROBIC STRENGTH
 - V. MENTAL STRENGTH
-

<http://www.RealAthlete.com>

A Division of TeamMastermind.com

"The Mental Strength principles taught by TeamMastermind will help every athlete, regardless of level, achieve Peak Performance."

- Sheldon Kannegiesser, 12 years, NHL
N.Y. Rangers and L.A. Kings

"TeamMastermind's services have exceeded my expectations. My bodybuilding career is skyrocketing because of these principles."

- Brian Maltese, President, NatureLife, Inc.
ISSA Fitness Trainer, Phoenix, AZ

"TeamMastermind helped me become number one for a Division I college tennis team."

- Steve Tallakson, Tennis
#1 for UC Irvine, 1996-1997

"Thanks to the products and information from TeamMastermind I was able to compete with professional surfers that I thought would blow me away."

- Brian Roney, Professional surfer
Santa Barbara, Ca

"The Mental Strength principles taught by TeamMastermind / RealAthlete are right on. They have helped my bodybuilding lifestyle tremendously."

- M'Lou Keller, Bodybuilder
Former Ms. Ventura County & Ms. South Pacific

"RealAthlete has helped my career so much. I am totally thankful."

- Robert Evans, Cyclist
Winner of the 50-mile Animal Challenge

"Mental Strength is the critical ingredient to all athletes. TeamMastermind / RealAthlete explain the most complicated of principles in plain and simple terms enabling all athletes to excel."

- Julie Tulberg, USPTA Tennis Professional
All-American, USC

"I've never been more relaxed on the playing field. The mental training taught by TeamMastermind is the best I've ever seen."

- Daimond Dixon, Football player
Former Tailback for the Miami Hurricanes
President of Pro Power Athletics

"My gains have been tremendous. I have put 60 pounds on my bench press after working out for 3 months. I credit your limit and mental strength manuals for giving me the tools to become a more powerful person."

- Robert Wall, Baseball player
Villanova University, PA

"Prepare yourself for some serious results in your sport. You'll be more mentally prepared after you're done studying the Mental Strength and Peak Performance training manual."

- Ed Croson, San Diego State tennis team, 1993,
Black belt in Tae Kwon Do and bodybuilder



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**The difference between good
and great is MentalStrength.com**

Mental Strength And Peak Performance

www.RealAthlete.com

Where Real Athletes Make It Happen

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Warning: Serious Coaches and Athletes Only

This is not hype. This is an intense mental strength training manual. It is not intended for anyone who:

- Has no interest in being mentally tough;
- Has no interest in operating in the peak performance zone;
- Does not have the capacity to learn;
- Cannot go against the norm;
- Does not want to achieve peak performance;
- And above all, is unable to work hard.

Turn the page ... Only if you qualify.

If you do not qualify:

You can take advantage of TeamMastermind's
money back guarantee.

Although we might notify your competition.

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How to read this manual for best results

We're all busy. We are bombarded with information. There's not enough time in the day to go through the mounds of paperwork thrown on our desks. *How can we as athletes and coaches get to the real information that will truly benefit us?*

This manual is uniquely designed for the busy coach or athlete

TeamMastermind is composed of coaches and athletes. We are very aware that you would rather be investing your time on the track, in the gym, or in the pool. We want to help you get on the field in the quickest time possible, and receive maximum results.

Here's what we have done:

Every word in this manual can be of benefit to you. Although there are some points that are more critical to your success than others. The intention is for you to read every word in this manual. But that isn't always possible.

You need to get the critical information that can launch your career to new heights. Here is a simple, effective system for you to pull out the most critical information in this manual. And store it in your long-term memory. Right now.

Read this manual in under 25 minutes:



1. Read only the paragraphs that are indented. These paragraphs always have an athlete next to them. These are the critical success points for you to Build Mental Strength.
2. Store this information into your long-term memory. Read these critical success points in this order:
 - a. Once; 1st reading _____(put date here)
 - b. Again in 24 hours; 2nd reading _____
 - c. Again in 7 days; 3rd reading _____
 - d. Again in 30 days; 4th reading _____

Read each indented section at least twice before moving on. It will sink in only after several readings. When it sinks in, your career is unlimited. You will have no competition. And you will virtually write your own paycheck.



Building the Ultimate Athlete

1 Athlete - 5 Strengths

The Pentagon of Strength

"Strength is the universal requirement
of all athletes in every sport."

Strength is a misunderstood principle in the world of sports and athletics. Your development of strength must be carefully planned and executed. If not, you could be harming your potential rather than realizing it.

www.PureAthlete.com

The Ultimate Store For Explosive Speed



Strength is made of five important components. You need a unique combination of these five strengths working together to excel in your sport of choice. You would need an entirely different set of strengths as a basketball player, or as a linebacker in football.

By reading and studying this report, and the others that follow, you will have a new awareness of where you need to focus to achieve athletic success.

The strength of a marathon runner doesn't even compare to that of a linebacker

- World-class sprinter Marion Jones counts on her strength to ignite her body off the line in the 100-meter sprint.
- Oscar De La Hoya relies upon his strength to persevere through a 12-round fight.
- Jerry Rice's strength has led him to be the top wide receiver in football history.

Not all strengths are equal. You will begin to understand how you can enhance virtually every aspect of your key development areas of your sport by increasing your Pentagon of Strength. Many athletes and coaches misunderstand the importance of strength. Most athletes do not use the full value of strength to maximize their potential.

Strength is not just a word that bodybuilders, powerlifters, and weightlifters toss around. All successful athletes have a high level of their Pentagon of Strength.

The Pentagon of Strength * :



- I. Limit Strength**
- II. Speed Strength**
- III. Anaerobic Strength**
- IV. Aerobic Strength**
- V. Mental Strength**

* TeamMastermind offers an information packed free newsletter to help athletes and coaches achieve the slight-edge in their training and competition. Enroll online at www.TeamMastermind.com.

Some strengths are less important than others as it relates to your sport. The common denominator among all peak athletes is a higher than average level of sport-specific strengths. You must focus on developing the specific combination of strength required of your sport.

Just as you need a combination to open a lock, you need to find your combination of strength to increase your potential as an athlete.

The first step is to achieve a solid base of physical strength – limit strength. This is where a good coach, mentor, or trainer is invaluable to help you locate and build upon your weak areas.

Mental Strength is the most critical of the five strengths

Strength – the ability to exert force against an object – has five components. All of them working together in the right combination is critical to success in any sport. These five ‘strengths’ are known as the Pentagon of Strength, and are as follows:

I. Limit Strength

Limit strength is the amount of musculoskeletal force one can generate for a single, all-out effort. This type of strength is usually built in the weight room. Although there are ways to build limit strength on the tennis court, football field, track, etc.

An adequate level of limit strength must be developed to reach higher levels of speed strength, anaerobic strength, and aerobic strength. And as you make an increase in any of your physical strengths, your mental strength is raised because of an increase in confidence. Therefore limit strength is the foundation of an athlete.

With too much focus on limit strength, one might end up adding 10 lbs. of muscle mass that could create problems – as tennis player Andre Agassi did a few years ago. His tennis career was hurt because of it, until he dropped the weight and focused on functional limit strength.

You probably want great limit strength in your calves and thighs (hamstrings and quadriceps), a strong upper body (yet not bulky), and a strong, flexible trunk (abdominals and erector muscles).

II. Speed strength - www.PureAthlete.com

The Russians believed that 'speed is everything,' and they produced some of the best athletes and training methods the world has ever seen. Speed strength is critical to most anaerobic athletes. Speed strength is the application of force with velocity. Movements that employ 'fast-twitch' muscle fibers characterize speed strength. Fast-twitch muscle fibers are those that respond rapidly but fatigue quickly. Speed strength is of two types:

- a. **Starting strength**—The ability to 'turn on' many muscle fibers (muscle cells) instantaneously determines your starting speed strength. Throwing a 100-m.p.h. fastball is an activity requiring starting speed strength. Tennis players Greg Rusedski and Mark Philippousses have tremendous starting speed strength that is very apparent in their 140-m.p.h.-and-above serves.
- b. **Explosive strength**—Once your muscle fibers are 'turned on,' the ability to leave them on is a function of your explosive speed strength. The five-yard acceleration to a soccer ball is an example of explosive speed strength. Explosiveness occurs just after the 'starting' of an activity requiring speed. Linebackers in football, tennis players, and sprinters all require a high explosive speed strength.

III. Anaerobic strength

The word 'anaerobic' means without oxygen. If your muscles do not need oxygen supplied to them during an activity, you are performing an 'anaerobic' activity. You need oxygen to survive, so when you have completed the 'anaerobic' activity, you repay your muscles by breathing hard. This is when you payback your body for the 'debt' of oxygen. Because of this, a 5-10 yard sprint is much more of an anaerobic activity than an 'aerobic' activity. 'Anaerobic' endurance is made of two characteristics:

- a. **Linear anaerobic endurance**— Linear means that the same movement is done repeatedly, like a weightlifter doing 10 repetitions on the squat rack. The ability to sustain all-out running speed, as Carl Lewis does in the 100-meter

sprint, is an example of linear anaerobic endurance. Even the elite sprinters, like Carl Lewis or Ben Johnson, fatigue in the latter half of a 100-meter sprint. The degree to which they tire is a measure of their anaerobic endurance.

- b. **Non-Linear anaerobic endurance**—The ability to play tennis with exceeding explosiveness for the length of a tennis match is a measure of non-linear anaerobic endurance. The tennis players with the best five-set victory records have a high non-linear anaerobic endurance.

IV. Aerobic strength

Aerobic strength is critical to all athletes. It is the critical factor to a marathon runner. Unlike 'anaerobic,' the term 'aerobic' means with oxygen. The efficiency to which you are able to feed your working muscles with oxygen and relieve them of the metabolic waste products that accumulate is your cardiovascular endurance. Just like 'anaerobic' strength, your aerobic strength is comprised of two categories:

- a. **Linear aerobic endurance**—An example of an 'aerobic' activity is running a marathon, or rowing a boat. Any repetitive movement done all-out and recurrently, such as a running stride in a marathon is a linear aerobic movement.
- b. **Non-linear aerobic endurance**—An 'aerobic' activity with frequent time interruptions, like in a fast paced soccer or basketball game. A non-linear aerobic activity can take place over a three-hour time frame with frequent stops and starts, which may be comprised of running, kicking, jumping, etc.

V. Mental Strength www.MentalStrength.com



Mental strength is your essential key to becoming a better than average athlete. Your mental strength is based on these principles:

1. The ability to be calm and relaxed in all situations,
2. Letting your habits and beliefs take over, and
3. Keeping the conscious mind from becoming involved with the process, this is sometime referred to as 'thinking too much.'

Because of the mental strength needed, sports can be up to 90 percent mental at the higher levels of competition. Not everyone will be competing at these levels, although most would like to achieve a higher level of success; which you will when you understand and apply TeamMastermind's Mental Strength principles.

To monitor your own mental strength, ask yourself provocative questions such as;

- *"Do little things aggravate me?"*
- *"Am I easily frenzied?"*
- *"Am I able to concentrate single mindedly on the task at hand?"*
- *"Do I say things to myself such as, 'If I don't start fast, I'll lose.'" Causing myself to lose focus easily.*

There is always room for an increase in one pillar or a combination of pillars in the pentagon of strength. You can follow the footsteps of athletes such as Michael Chang, Carl Lewis, and hundreds of other elite athletes.

<http://www.TeamMastermind.com>



Athletes Helping Athletes Achieve the Slight-Edge

Pillar V
The Pentagon of Strength

Mental Strength
Secrets to Mental Toughness

You are an athlete.
Your goal is to play, train,
and compete as effortlessly,
powerfully, and effectively as possible.
This requires mental toughness.
Mental strength.

“What keeps an athlete from being mentally tough?”

This manual is about using your mind in sports. You will become a better athlete. And, you will have a new awareness about your most powerful tool – your mind.

Most athletes think that mental strength just happens. As if you either have it or you don't. If this is the case, why then do competitors of superior athletic ability frequently compete at a lower level than those of lesser athletic ability?

Matt Biondi was an average athlete. He didn't reek of fantastic athletic skills. Although, he had the Midas Touch when it came to swimming. *Every time he touched water it seemed to turn to gold.* Biondi won 11 Olympic medals. Seven of which were Gold. What makes him different from other athletes desiring similar results? **Matt Biondi developed mental toughness.**

Your mind has the capacity to operate in a peak mental state. Sometimes referred to as the zone. This is a very sought after state-of-mind. Throughout this manual, the zone will be used interchangeably with being mentally tough, or having peak mental strength.

There are some differences between the zone and being mentally tough. Although, we will assume that working on a mental fitness program and the principles taught in this manual, will be the same as searching for the zone, as for becoming mentally strong.

During my tennis career, like all athletes, I spent countless hours learning and refining physical techniques to increase my current level of play. While this is critical to success, it was being done to get that edge to play a better match.

The competitive edge is in your head

This is a manual for athletes, coaches, trainers, and anyone wanting to attain more control over the most sought after and elusive topic in sports – the mind.



Athletes and coaches developed this manual ... for athletes and coaches. Everything that is said and practiced in the pages to follow is written for the athlete desiring better performance.

With the aid of the most powerful weapon in your arsenal – your mind – you can have control over the peak performance zone. And you will be mentally tough.

The beautiful thing about sports is that all athletic analogies, quotes, and principles are closely linked to almost anything that is done in life.

Life is the same as athletics

–Roger Staubach
Dallas Cowboys Quarterback
NFL Hall of Fame

Mental strength is not an elusive thing; it is a very real, certain process that anyone can implement during his or her training and competition.

“You never conquer the mountain, you only conquer yourself.”

–Jim Whitaker,
mountaineer, during an
assault on Mount Everest

Wishing you best of success,

Samuel F. Hirschberg
Senior Editor
TeamMastermind, Inc.

P.S. If you have any questions, comments, or positive input that you would like to share with other athletes and coaches, please email Win@TeamMastermind.com.

Being Mentally Tough

How the Pros Compete in the Peak Performance Zone

"When it happens you are in total control. Nothing bothers you."

-Tom Kite

1989 PGA Player of the Year

1992 U.S. Open Champion

Every athlete knows the incredible feeling of being 'in the zone' during competition or in training. It is a feeling of pure ecstasy.

"You can't miss anything. It's like you anticipate, way ahead of time, earlier than usual, where the ball is going and you also know where you're going to hit the ball before you hit it."

Chris Evert

2nd in all time tennis tournament wins

You peak, mentally and physically, simultaneously. Attaining this state is the challenge for most athletes. Some people refer to this as a feeling of selflessness, or as Chris Evert says, *"being at peace with the whole scene."* Bruce Lee referred to and taught this level of activity as being the art of 'flowing,' as if you were moving with the same ease as water.

With so many fantastically talented people searching for the zone, why do so few consistently operate at this peak level of play? As you read the pages to follow, you will have a new understanding of why you do things; and why you don't. This is the core of the zone, and when you understand why you do things the way you do, and how to change them, you will be able to find the zone.

Olympic marathon runner Margaret Groos says, *"I know exactly if it's going to be my race or not. I feel effortless – a floating sensation. I feel like the race is taking care of itself. I have that feeling every once in a while in workouts, too It's just this psychological thing where I feel very focused."*

"On days that it was there, the ball just came up to the plate and stopped for me. I said, 'Okay, I'm going to hit this to left center,' or 'I'm going to hit it to right center.' Being in the Zone, that's what happens. Everything just stops. You're not hurried in anything you do. It just happens."

- Don Baylor
1979 Baseball MVP
California Angels

How do top athletes stay mentally tough?

Bill Walton relates his experiences with the zone and being mentally strong in his basketball career,

"... everything slows down except you ... the clarity of your senses is maxed out, and everybody else looks like their eyes are just fogged over. You try to call it up, but you really can't. So what you try to do is re-create the same situation each and every game by routine ..."

Athletes of all skill level are desperately trying to reach this peak level of play. Most athletes know that it has something to do with the mind, but the majority do not know to what extent. Could it be as simple as flipping a switch to turn on the lights?

Greg Norman, is known in the world of golf as 'the Shark.' He won two U.S. Opens with the belief that; *"the inner being is what takes you to another level."* This inner being is simply your mind.



Players of all levels attempt to reproduce the zone by recreating their pregame routines. They make *this* the habit to construct in an attempt to achieve peak mental strength.

When attempting a free throw, basketball players such as Larry Bird or Magic Johnson, duplicate their pre-shot pattern to raise their probability of success. They perform the same stance and the same breathing pattern. They even bounce the ball the same way and the same number of times. This repetitive behavior is done in an attempt to put their mind at ease before they shoot.



Superstar football athletes Jerry Rice and Deion Sanders create a ritual as they line up their clothes before their games. They do this to try to reproduce peak play and a relaxed state-of-mind that Walton, Evert, Kite, and Lee refer to.

Creating a pregame routine like these may be helpful to the athlete in some cases. But it really has nothing to do with the outcome of their performance. The routine, although familiar, can be performed without putting the player at ease.

Staying relaxed during performance is the real test.

In Mental Training for Peak Performance, Dr. Steven Ungerleider tells the story of three-time Olympic sprint champion Harvey Glance. Glance would hang out at the track signing autographs to relax his mind until race time.

The problem, as Bill Walton alludes to, is that this peak state-of-mind seems to be extremely elusive. It seems to come and go as it pleases and is rather uncontrollable for 99% of even the most gifted of athletes and performers.

Master gymnast Bart Connor earned two Gold medals in the 1984 Olympic games, his experiences with peak mental strength are much like all the other high level athletes that we know of,

"The zone, to me, is the ultimate rush. You wish you could bottle it up and save it for another day. I don't know anyone who's been able to find it and recreate it at will."

How do you find peak mental performance?



It is a simple truth that this incredibly desired state-of-mind is operated and controlled by the mind. It has to be; there is nowhere else to look. For this simple reason, this is the place to start when in search of the zone and mental toughness.



No one in the western part of the world has been able to give people an easy understanding of mental performance. And how it can be realized in athletics. For most, it seems as though the harder you try, the farther you get from being able to reach mental peak performance. We quote the old Zen masters when they say,

"When you seek it, you can not find it."

Athletes are now taking on a better understanding of the importance of the mind (the relationship between the conscious mind and the subconscious mind) to their training, competition, and overall well being. Incredibly talented people are desperately seeking mental peak performance.

In *Winning Ugly*, by Brad Gilbert, Andre Agassi says,

"... it's amazing how players limit their physical talents by not utilizing their mental talents. My mind used to be my weakness because I didn't think I needed to use it. I thought I could just go out there and hit harder than the other guy."

Ex-tennis professional turned coach Brad Gilbert wrote in *Winning Ugly*, on the topic of how to prepare your mind mentally against specific player styles and strategies. Gilbert created an excellent book about mental preparation, although mental peak performance remains an enigma to his athletes,



"He believes that 5 percent of the time your opponent is in the Zone and you won't win; 5 percent of the time you're in the Zone and can't lose. But the other 90 percent of the time it's up for grabs..."

What would it mean to you if you could tap into a higher percentage of the remaining 90 percent that Gilbert is referring? What if you *could* train your mind to reach this mental zone?



It *is* your mind, and it is your body. You own it, and you can control it. Why else would Albert Einstein say that imagination is more valuable than knowledge?

When Einstein developed the Theory of Relativity, he imagined what it would feel like to ride on a beam of light. Can you imagine what it feels like to be training and competing in the mental peak performance zone? Of



course you can. This is the first step to attaining mental toughness.

When you are able to take control of your mind and thoughts, your athletic career (of your physical capacity) will be unlimited. Your physical abilities will improve as your mental abilities improve. If you want to be the best, and you want better mental performance, you must learn to control your mind.

Can You Control Your Mental Performance?

A professional baseball player that bats a .200 (2 hits out of 10 at bats) may earn the industry average annual income. But, a baseball player that hits one more time, and bats a .300 (3 out of 10) can earn many millions of dollars per year.

You *can* create the edge, which can be created by being mentally strong. You can get one more hit at bat, or shave one more half-second (0.5 sec) off a 100 meter dash, or rid yourself of that hitch in your service swing, or whatever your case may be. *There is a lot riding on that edge, isn't there?*

The purpose of this simple and easy-to-read manual is to give you a blueprint that you can follow to become mentally stronger. Mental strength is not an elusive quality. Anyone *can* implement these principles and universal laws during their training and competition.



The zone and mental peak performance is a very simple process. Albert Einstein understood the power of his mind probably more than anyone in the Western world. It has been said that he used more of his potential (his mind) than anyone that we know of. The same can be true for you, when *you* understand this information you will be able to release a larger portion of your potential in whatever field of endeavor you choose.

Several thousand books have been written about the how-tos of sporting activities. This manual is about much more than stance, swings, or perfecting jumps. You can



find that information at any bookstore pertaining to almost any sport. This manual offers you a simple understanding of how your mind works, and how you can be mentally tough and implement the peak performance zone into your sport.

How Do You Do Achieve Better Mental Performance?

Johnny Miller won 23 PGA championships. He was also the 1973 U.S. Open champion. He came very close to pinpointing mental peak performance in Charlie Jones book, *What Makes Winners Win*. Even for such a successful golfer there is still an air of doubt about mental strength,

"The zone is the most elusive thing in sports, maybe one of the most exclusive clubs in the world."



After studying the training habits and winning thought processes of thousands of successful athletes, business people, and peak achievers, TeamMastermind has found similarities that you can use to achieve a peak state-of-mind.

None of the information that we are relaying to you is new. This information will only be new to you because this will be your first exposure. Once you understand the information and are able to apply it, you will then be able to teach it. You will explain it in your own words. And from your own personality. You will own it. And you will literally *Own the Zone*.

The bottom line



Creating the zone and mental strength in your life can be compared to placing yourself on automatic pilot. Just like an airplane does. An airplane does what it is instructed to do by the programmer. It does not argue with the instructions. An airplane will have no problem flying into the side of a mountain; if that is what it is instructed to do by the programmer.



Read the statement to follow several times. Read it slowly. Internalize it. This is the root of the zone and mental strength. Translate it so that it fits into your sport:

'When your habits and re-actions are working with the activity that you love to do, and your conscious mind is focused solely on the present moment (focused intensity), you will be operating in your peak performance zone.'

You need to learn to program your mind for successful results on the track, in the gym, or on the court. The remainder of this manual will teach you how. TeamMastermind's coaches and athletes are always available to help, although you are responsible for the rest.



Athletes Helping Athletes Achieve the Slight-Edge

Your Mind

The Conscious and Subconscious Mind

Your mind.

It can be the difference between
your winning and losing.

Between 1st place and 2nd place.
Or between 4th place and dead last.

Your Mind

The Conscious and Subconscious Mind

The mind is made of two distinct parts; call them spheres; the conscious mind, and the subconscious mind.

The conscious mind is known as the reasoning mind, or the thinking mind. This is the part of Muhammad Ali's mind that said, *"I am the greatest!"* Then he became the greatest by defeating Joe Frazier. Or, when Billy Mills won the Gold in the 1964 Tokyo Olympic games, his conscious mind said, *"I can win, I can win, I can win!"* ... then he broke the tape.

The relationship between the conscious mind and the subconscious mind can be compared to a computer.



The definition and purpose of a computer is to perform a useful function at the command of a person or signal. The user, programmer, or designer of the computer sets the criterion of usefulness. Every athlete has an unlimited computer in his/her mind. As an athlete or coach, you can operate your mind – or computer – how you see fit.



Athletes' physical limits are always being stretched. Athletes are continually becoming quicker, faster, and stronger. There are obvious limitations of the human body that can never be broken, but the mind has never reached a limit. The only limits are the ones that are placed upon oneself. For this reason, more records will be broken.

By studying the laws to follow, you are on your way to a new awareness about your most powerful tool – your mind.

The Law of Cause and Effect

The Law of Cause and Effect is the Granddaddy of all laws. When you implement this law, you will become unstoppable.



Everything that we do is done for a reason. Everything that happens happens for a reason. We live in an orderly universe. For every cause, there is an effect. There are no accidents and there is no luck.

The most successful people in the world say, '*the harder I work (cause), the luckier I get (effect).*' Therefore implementing the Law of Cause and Effect. The Law of Cause and Effect is a Universal Law, much like the Law of Gravity. This is a law that cannot be broken.

Try telling Jerry Rice that he is lucky. He'll rip your head off. He works harder than anyone on that field. Even harder than guys ten years younger. Tell Michael Jordan he's lucky. He practiced his lay-ups and jumps hundreds of times per day. This is after he got cut from his high school basketball team.

You create your own luck. It's called hard work.



The way you think is subject to the Law of Cause and Effect. When you hold a thought, it will produce a result. If you hold productive, positive thoughts, you will receive productive and positive results. This one law, when implemented towards your athletic endeavor will work magic in your life.

*"Cause and effect; seed and fruit;
Means and ends; cannot be severed."*

—Ralph Waldo Emerson



Your thoughts are incredibly important. Thought travels at the speed of light; it is the most effective form of energy. Most athletes use this energy thinking about the things they don't want. Doing this causes little improvement in one's athletic career. It is like taking two steps forward and two steps back.

Because of negative thinking (cause), people see no real improvement (effect) in their athletic lives. Decide right now that you are going to implement the law of cause and effect to your training. When you do, you are on your way to truly excelling in your career, and in your life.

The Law of Mind



The first and most critical law of mental strength is the Law of Mind. The Law of Mind says that thoughts objectify themselves. They become real. Or, in other words, you will become what you think about.

If you think – or worry – about losing, or your mind is filled with fearful thoughts of performing badly, the law of mind says that you will eventually lose and perform badly.

“... it is your world within, namely your thoughts, feelings and, imagery that make your world without. It is, therefore, the only creative power, and everything which you find in your world of expression has been created by you in the inner world of your mind consciously or unconsciously.”

–Dr. Joseph Murray

Bruce Jenner was crowned the greatest athlete in the world after winning the Gold medal in the Decathlon in the 1976 Olympic games. Jenner filled his mind with good thoughts of winning and achieving success prior to the games. He filled his mind with exactly what he wanted to the smallest detail. He even put pictures of himself breaking the tape on the ceiling above his bed.

The rest is history.

“Thoughts of doubt and fear never accomplish anything, and never can. They always lead to failure.”

–James Allen

Clear and Concise Goals

Your mind is capable of nearly anything. Your potential has not been touched. The power of the human mind is known as the "mystery of all mysteries."



Set clear goals. Put the Law of Mind to work for you. Set clear training goals and competition goals. And clear weight goals. Set a clear, well thought out goal of what you want to achieve in your sport. After all, a goal is a thought. Apply the Law of Cause and Effect with the Law of Mind.

The Law of Mind says that whatever your mind dwells upon most often will come to reality in your life. Direct and accurate thinking is the most important trait you can possess on your way to greatness as an athlete. A clear, concise goal is a product of direct and accurate thinking.

Direct and accurate thinking is a priceless asset to an athlete. It can only be acquired through discipline. When you study great athletes who have accomplished a lot in their careers, you will find that they were able to control their thoughts. They possessed the habit of accurate thinking. They applied it to their training. And they achieved success.

The Conscious Mind

All success starts in one form – a clear, definite thought.



The conscious mind accounts for about 10 percent of your mind. The conscious has been called such things as the logical mind, reasoning mind, or the thinking mind. This part of the mind controls the thoughts you hold and dwell upon. The conscious mind can only hold one thought at a time. We tell our clients,

“Be very careful of what you think about, because what you think about will happen.”

Your thoughts can be compared to a beautiful, lush, garden spot. With organized effort and discipline, it can be a home for a bed of roses. Or, food for attainment of a healthy and active body. However, with neglect (which accounts for the majority of athletes) and lack of the necessary ingredients, it will become a dry, non-productive, weed stricken piece of land.

During the winter Olympic games in Nagano, Japan, the United States hockey team was one of the favorites to win the Gold medal. The U.S. hockey team provided a great example of how to be mentally weak. These particular professionals earn a tremendous annual income. They also had the honor of representing the United States in world competition.

“Your conscious mind makes decisions for you.”

— Leslie Brice, Founder of Gateways Institute

The night before one of the games, a couple of the hockey players were found at the local bar until nearly four in the morning. Are these the actions of a highly rewarded and respected professional the night before one of the greatest events in history? You decide.

The fact is, these actions produced a high load of stress on their teammates. The players who were out late were not able to give peak performance. The workload was intensified on the others. These actions are not the actions of a professional. Nor are they the actions of an athlete who our youth looks up to with passion. There was absolutely no excuse for this.

The Subconscious Mind

"Championship mental strength is an activity of your subconscious mind."

– Leslie Brice, Founder of Gateways Institute



Your subconscious mind (SCM) is your master key to athletic success. The subconscious accounts for about 90 percent of your mind. Everything that has ever happened to you is stored in your SCM. This is the storehouse for everything that is in your life.

The data that is stored in your SCM forms your athletic ability. It is your subconscious that controls your successes, and your failures.

The conscious mind can only hold one thought at a time. Yet the SCM works about 30,000 times faster. The number of functions that are simultaneously controlled by the subconscious mind has not yet been determined. Although it is probably in the millions.

Your subconscious mind controls;

- Your breathing
- Your running stride length
- Jumping ease and height
- Heart rate
- Your Pentagon of Strength
- How you compete
- Your senses
- And much, much more; all while competing



Inside your subconscious are bits of information. This information controls everything that you do. And everything that you don't do. These bits of information are called your self-concept. You have a self-concept for everything. Your life is literally made up of thousands of mini self-concepts.

You have a self-concept for EVERYTHING that you do. Your self-concept is what dictates how well you do what you

do. If you win, it is because it is consistent with your self-concept. If you lose it is because it's consistent with your self-concept.



You have a mini self-concept for every action you take on the football field, tennis court, track, weight room, etc. And for everything you do – regardless of how miniscule you think it might be. The goal is always to raise your self-concept. And you can always raise it.

- *Do you know why you bounce the tennis ball three times before you serve?*
- *Do you know why you bounce the ball one extra time on a critical point?*
- *Why do you rub your cheek before you shoot a free throw?*
- *Why do you wear your favorite article of clothing every game?*

The job of your subconscious mind is to store pieces of data. When you need to call upon this information, it is the job of your SCM to retrieve it for you.

You must train your mind with as much intensity as you train your body.

The subconscious responds to goals, commands, feelings and emotions. Your subconscious will work wonders for you as you learn to give it these proper commands that are consistent with your goals.



Napoleon Bonaparte said, *"I will either find a way or make one."* He understood the power of the mind. You can do the same with your mind. Your subconscious mind *'will either find a way or make one,'* when you control your conscious thoughts, and build habits that are consistent with your primary goals.

The subconscious mind cannot differentiate between these scenarios;

- 1.) What the conscious deems reality, and
- 2.) A thought that has been created by the conscious.

This is the secret to creating any amount of success in your sport that you desire and are physically capable of achieving. You literally are a compilation of every bit of information that has been put into your subconscious mind. And you can change it!

The Law of the Self-concept

- Your self-concept dictates whether you have the habit of winning or the habit of losing
- Your self-concept dictates whether or not you have the habit of persisting or quitting
- It determines whether or not you play to win, or if you play 'not to lose'
- It determines whether you pass the ball on 3rd down and 7
- And it determines your relaxed state-of-mind on 4th and 1.



Your self-concept is a set of beliefs and principles that you believe to be true about yourself. These beliefs are formulated by your conscious mind and are secured in place within your subconscious mind. Whether you like it or not, you are responsible for your beliefs. And now everything you do is first regulated by your self-concept to see if it's consistent with these beliefs.

Every action you take is first checked by your self-concept. If your self-concept does not like the action, you probably won't act. Or, you will take action and since your self-concept says 'you aren't very good at that,' you will perform badly.

Mark Phillippousses was the holder of the fastest serve in the world at 142 miles per hour. His self-concept for hitting the serve is much higher than someone who hits a maximum serve of 120 miles per hour.

Your self-concept is a set of beliefs and habits locked inside your subconscious.

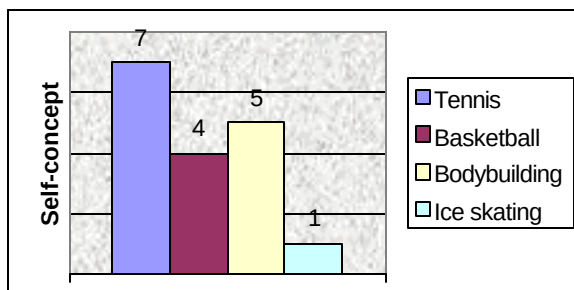


The better you are at a sport, the more success you will achieve. The more success you achieve, the better you will become. The better you become, the higher your self-concept is. Your self-concept controls everything that has to do with your sport. It is your self-concept that determines all your successes as a tennis player, long-distance runner, bodybuilder, quarterback, or speed skater, etc.



Notice the example of a tennis player's self-concept (on a relative scale of 1-10) as it relates to four different sports. As expected, a person's self-concept is always highest for the activity that he/she is best at, or has seen the most success with:

An athlete's self-concept for four different sports:



This is extremely important when we break the individual activity down further. In any sport, there must be a certain level of athletic ability that correlates with the sport of your choice.

This level of athletic ability can be labeled as your overall level of fitness, your Pentagon of Strength.

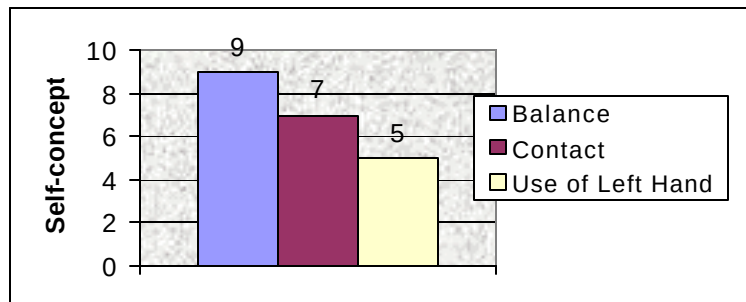
Go to www.TeamMastermind.com to order the **1 Athlete - 5 Strengths** *Building the Ultimate Athlete* training manual.



Basics comprise any sport. There are three basics in tennis: balance, contact, and the use of the left hand (right hand for a left-handed person). The mastery of these basics lay the foundation for achieving peak performance.

A competitive tennis player may have the following skills and the corresponding self-concept. The overall self-concept for the individual to follow is seven on a scale of 1-10. While there really is no way to put a person's self-concept on a scale, we will simply use this as an easy to grasp example for monitoring and comparison purposes.

A tennis players self-concept for mastery of the basics:



As you can see, a tennis player that has the skills of balance at a nine, contact skills at seven, and the use of left hand at five, collectively has a self-concept for the game of tennis at seven. The average of all the skills equal the self-concept.

This player would want to improve his weaknesses to become an overall better player. This would cause an increase in his self-concept. If you were able to raise this player's use of left hand so that his self-concept is a seven, this would increase his overall self-concept to an eight. This would substantially improve the productivity of the athlete – both mentally and physically.

In the above scenario, this player probably would be lacking appropriate shoulder rotation, racquet head speed, control of the racket, and several other effects of not using the left hand correctly (the cause).



The key to raising your abilities is increasing your self-concept. This should be your focus. Because it is the only true long-lasting success.

You always succeed when you improve yourself at the deepest levels of your mind.

- World-class sprinter Maurice Greene has a high self-concept for running the 100-meter sprint.
- Former San Francisco 49er's quarterback Joe Montana had developed a high self-concept for pressure situations.
- San Antonio Spurs Steve Kerr has a high self-concept for shooting 3-pt baskets.
- Shaquille O'Neill has a low self-concept for shooting free throws.

The bottom line



The goal is to raise your self-concept; here are the six steps to engrain productive and positive changes to the self-concept of your choice (subconscious). The higher your self-concept, the better you will be.

Make the **Law of the Self-Concept** work for you:



1. Set specific goals
2. Accept 100% responsibility for your actions and attitudes – understand that you are where you are, and what you are, because of your choices
3. Improve upon your basic skills – practice, practice, practice
4. Affirmations – a single, positive, present-tense statement (with emotion) consistent with your highest goals
5. Visualizations – a clear, concise picture that you create in your mind depicting your perfect outcome
6. Act as if it were impossible to fail

"To become a champion you must first look and act like a champion!"

–Muhammed Ali

"Mind, physiology and emotion are inextricably connected. Altering one will immediately produce a complimentary change in the other two.

–Jacob H. Jordan, M.D.
Total Mind and Body Training

Law of Affirmation



Affirmations have been a large topic over the last few years. Mostly among people looking for a quick fix who aren't willing to put forth the work ethic. Athletes that we work with see tremendous success from coupling affirmations with their already existing work ethic. You can do the same.

An affirmation is simply conveying a thought to your subconscious mind that is consistent with your highest goal;

- 1.) It is a single statement,
- 2.) It is stated in the positive,
- 3.) It is in the present tense, such as;

"I am the greatest!" –Muhammad Ali

"I feel light on my feet." –Nick Bollettieri

"I know I'm going to win." –Nick Bollettieri

"I can win, I can win, I can win." –Billy Mills

"I succeed." –Dr. Jonathan Parker

"It is good to be successful." –Dr. Jonathan Parker

"I am a winner!" –TeamMastermind

"I am unstoppable!" –Brian Tracy

Your conscious mind commands your subconscious mind by holding thoughts. The thoughts you hold with extreme repetition are normally accepted by the subconscious. Your SCM does exactly what it is told to do. It looks at what your conscious mind is dwelling upon most often. This is the Law of Affirmation; it is much like the Law of Mind.

We have students come to us and say,

"Why do I double fault when I told myself, 'I'm not going to miss my second serve!'"

An affirmation, or a thought, can produce negative results if it is stated in the negative. Study this statement carefully; *'I'm not going to miss my second serve!'* It seems as though it is a harmless statement ... or is it? ... This simple statement can be a command to this athlete's subconscious mind.

This is a harmful statement for at least two reasons:



- 1.) When a thought like this occurs, the athlete will recall a time when he/she missed the second serve. This creates a mental picture. This creates emotions and pictures that tell the subconscious mind to miss the serve.
- 2.) The more times this tennis player repeats the statement to herself, and acts on it, it can become a habit. A bad one. Triggering the SCM to carry out the instructions, whenever it brings up the statement.

Every action that you do, or do not do, and every thought that you hold can program your subconscious mind. Proper thought is the beginning point to the programming of your mind, habits, and athletic skills.



Affirmations, visualizations, and actions are simply variations of your thought. These three forms of thought, when used together, when the SCM is most apt to receive them, literally give you the ability to control your career in any sport. This is the primary reason that Napoleon Hill said,

"The sub-conscious mind is the source of man's greatest power."

Affirmations – “Why don’t they always work?”

Affirmations are excellent tools to command the subconscious. They are most effective when your SCM is in a state of relaxation.



When you say to yourself, “*I am the greatest*,” and in applying it to your sport, your SCM will reject it as false unless you really believe it. This is the reason that simply stating affirmations do not have a real effect on your actions.

Your thoughts are the groundwork for all of your failure and successes. Thoughts are the single most important thing in your life. Contrary to popular belief, you have full control over them. The thoughts that you hold and dwell upon determine your success or failure.

- Your thoughts can determine whether you make the second serve or if you double fault.
- Your thoughts can dictate whether you bogey on a par 5 or achieve an eagle.
- Your thoughts can direct whether or not you record a 9.2 or a 9.9 time on the track.
- Your thoughts can compose a perfect 10 on the gymnast floor, or they can determine an 8.7.
- Your thoughts are your failures.
- Your thoughts are your success.
- Your thoughts are your life.

“All achievements, whether in the business, {athletic}, intellectual, or spiritual world, are the result of definitely directed thought.”

—James Allen
As A Man Thinketh

The way that you think can even be the critical determinate in your life or your death. Dr. H. Spencer Lewis wrote a book called Mental Poisoning. He tells of the power of a thought, as it would serve in the negative. He tells of how a handful of people were victim to their own ‘mental poison,’ after searching and excavating King Tut’s tomb.

Affirmations were posted in the tomb. They warned people of the dangers that will befall them if they disturbed the tomb. All 22 people on this excavation who read these affirmations died of a serious disease. All within just a few years of this 'shortcoming.' It has been found that it was a disease that was impregnated into the mind, in the form of a thought! This unexplained happening dumbfounded the "experts."



Olympic hurdler Dick Fosbury was told that he would be unable to compete. He was told repeatedly that his technique known as the "Fosbury Flop" would not work. Fosbury overcame this negativity. He took control of his thoughts. And he went on to win the Gold medal in the 1968 Olympic games in Mexico. Not only did he win a Gold medal, but he also set an Olympic record.

You need to impress upon your subconscious mind with enough repetition until you believe your affirmations. This causes you to act on it. And most importantly, realize it, just as Muhammad Ali did. The common misunderstanding is bringing, or not bringing, the subconscious mind into a state that will accept this new soon-to-be 'truth.'



The subconscious mind is most accepting just before sleep. Simply put, this is known as the alpha state. In the alpha state, you are very relaxed and the subconscious is very accepting. You can enter this state at any time throughout the day. For guided affirmations and visualizations to increase athletic performance, see the Sports Performance cassette program by Dr. Jonathan Parker at www.TeamMastermind.com.

TeamMastermind suggests that you train your subconscious with affirmations and visualizations about 2-4 times per day. This can take about 10-15 minutes and will bring you massive results. Incorporate this type of training into your daily routine just as you would your physical training routine. And watch your effectiveness skyrocket!

Law of Visualization – Mental Movies



The Law of Visualization says that whatever you picture in your mind (and what is accepted), will program your mind to act upon the picture. This is a critical step to an athlete desiring better results.

The clearer and more vivid you are able to picture in your mind your desired result, the quicker you will make it a reality. This is why you must have clear, definite goals to act on.

Visualizations are another form of affirmations. They program the subconscious with the result that you desire. The SCM does exactly as it is told to do by the conscious. The conscious communicates to the subconscious in the form of thoughts; affirmations, visualizations, and actions.

Visualizing is very simple. The more senses and emotion that you are able to involve, the more it will impress upon your subconscious as reality. This is why visualizing your desired outcome is so powerful.

Anybody can visualize. *"What side of the car is your steering wheel on?"* The only way you can answer that quickly is to picture it in your mind – with a visualization.

Thoughts and emotion



Thoughts of failure can be devastating. Primarily because a picture can be associated with it. When a picture is involved, it can awaken strong emotions and feelings. **A thought that is reinforced with emotion is generally injected directly into the subconscious.** Regardless of how much repetition.

Emotions are huge to the programming of the SCM. They can be compared to a large syringe that a doctor would inject you with. A picture with strong emotions can be injected directly into the SCM.

The SCM then acts to see that the command is completed. When you think a negative thought and create the picture of failure, your subconscious is merely telling the body to act.

When you do this with purpose, you are implementing a common method called neuro-linguistic programming, or NLP. When done purposefully, it would probably be for a positive result, because when you act with purpose you are acting on a goal.

Success coach Anthony Robbins became a master of helping people rid themselves of bad habits – and teaching people to replace them with good ones. He uses this technique called NLP.

"I never dream about losing. Positive thinking makes it happen sooner or later."

Matt Ghaffari
Greco-Roman wrestling
Silver Medallist
1996 Olympic games



Surprisingly small amounts of athletes use visualization training to raise their potential for success. Mental training will always help your physical performance. But physical training does not always help you mentally.

Dr. Steven Ungerleider did a survey among 1200 Olympic athletes. He found how often these elite athletes tend to use visualization training:

- Once a week or less: about one in three;
- Twice a week: one in five;
- Three to six times a week: about one in three;
- More than seven times a week; one in ten.

We initially found this rather shocking to learn that only about 1 in 10 of the best athletes in the world train visually at least once a day. With so little mental training you can understand why there are so few peak achievers.

The understanding of your mind is more important to your athletic success than the understanding of your physical training. Your mind controls your body. You can never achieve peak physical performance without the use of your mind.



Joe Dinoffer, of Oncourt Offcourt Inc., relates an experiment done with the Boston Celtics professional basketball team. Before practicing free throws, the team was split into two groups, Team A and Team B.

Team A was told to visualize the perfect free throw in their mind as their warm-up. Team B warmed up the way they have done for several years, shooting free throws. When the time came to shoot free throws, guess which team had the better success rate? Team A; the team that warmed up visualizing their success.

When the time comes for you to train physically, you will waste time and energy if you do not train mentally first. For example, let's assume that you are a competitive wrestler and you want to gain six pounds of lean body mass (LBM) to best compete in your weight class. If you are not a wrestler, and/or you do not want to gain weight, use the same analogy for your weight training goals, or athletic goals.

With the goal of gaining six pounds of LBM in X amount of weeks, you obviously want to maximize your physical energy. Schedule the times throughout the week (and ensuing weeks) that you will train in the gym. Then compose written affirmations (with emotion) consistent with gaining six pounds of LBM:

- "Yes! I gained 6 lbs. of muscle!"
- "I enjoy weight training to achieve my goals."
- "I only eat clean, enriching foods that help me create lean body mass."
- "I thoroughly enjoy achieving my weight training goals."
- "I'm ecstatic to be realizing my daily objectives."
- "I'm ecstatic to be gaining X ounces of lean body mass every day!"

With these commands, you are telling your SCM exactly what to be done. Your mind wants to help you succeed. It does exactly what you program it to do.

How do you expect it to give you gold if you think 'garbage,' talk 'garbage' and act 'garbage?' Reserve about 15 minutes a day, 2-4 times a day before and after physical training to relax so the subconscious will accept your commands.

During these 15 minutes, when your mind is most open, be extra careful of what goes into your mind. It's at this time when you need to couple the affirmations with visualizing exactly what you intend to look like, feel like, and how much better you will perform with these six pounds of added lean bodyweight. The goal of a mental visualization session is to create the perfect world inside your mind.



TeamMastermind's ALL STAR SPORTS PERFORMANCE (By Dr. Jonathan Parker) audiocassette program is the best in the industry. It has several guided visualization sessions and affirmation sessions for you to train your mind to compete at optimal levels.

Jonathan Parker also is the creator of the legendary 16-cassette audio program, **Build a Winning Self-Image**, which is also available through TeamMastermind.

When visualizing and imagining your success, you want to create your perfect world to the smallest detail. At one time Pam Shriver was the #1 women's tennis doubles player in the world. She was not the best player on the tour. Nor was she the most physically fit. Although, she did know how to use her mind.

Before every serve she quickly relaxed her mind and body and visualized her perfectly placed serve doing exactly as she wanted. This raised her success and accuracy. You can do the same.



Visualization can be very harmful to your success if used incorrectly. When a negative thought arises it can bring negative pictures associated with it. A simple and effective training technique is to 'cancel' the thought immediately.

Imagine that you are wide open in the end zone awaiting the football from the quarterback, and your conscious mind gets in the way and says to your subconscious mind,

"If I miss this, I'll look pretty bad, and we'll probably lose the game."

If your conscious mind is not stopped, it will create a mental picture of you dropping the ball. Your SCM has the ability to take this as fact and will probably do just what it is told.

Caccius Clay, who changed his name to Muhammad Ali, was 22 years old at the time he challenged world heavyweight champion Sonny Liston. As you know, Clay continually affirmed to himself, *"I am the greatest!"*

Clay went one step further and told everyone (but most importantly told himself) that he was not only the greatest, but that he would knock out Liston in the 8th round – creating a more detailed inner picture. In 1964, Clay not only beat Liston, but at the end of the 7th round, Liston sat it out and did not even attempt to go on into the 8th round. Clay won that fight in an amazing way. A way in which the experts say is an 'unexplained' seven rounds.

Clay created his own self-fulfilling prophecy.

This is the reason that Albert Einstein said, *"Imagination is more important than knowledge."* Einstein knew that the human mind is literally the determining factor in imagining yourself to success, and into mental toughness.

Specific and productive affirmations, visualizations, and actions towards your athletic goals must be done to produce better habits.

Law of Input – Are you mentally fit ... or mentally sick?

Take control of the information that goes into your mind. This is the first step in controlling your thoughts. Among computer users there is a rule that says, 'GIGO – Garbage In, Garbage Out.' This rule is especially true for your mind as well. You are the programmer of your own mind. You can fill your mind with anything you choose.



You can choose to fill your mind with good, positive, productive information, or you can choose to let your surroundings fill your mind. It's your choice. Always. When you apply the law of input towards your goals you will have the slight-edge over your competition.

If you let society fill your mind, you will probably be filling it with 'garbage' information. Therefore, you will most likely produce 'garbage' results.



The byproduct of garbage input is a case of mental sickness. Also known as a bad attitude. A tremendous amount of athletes suffer from mental sickness. Lack of confidence in oneself, the inability to focus, or common negative-emotional outbursts that bring their performance down are traits of an athlete with mental sickness.

Most athletes don't have a clue of why they may be in a slump, or why they can't raise their game to the next level (raise their self-concept). Athletes that fall into this category all suffer from a case of mental sickness. The first step in fixing this is making the Law of Input work for you.

Phil Jackson, coach of the L.A. Lakers, has coached some of the greatest basketball players in history. He gets a self-improvement book for his players every season. He understands the Law of Input.

The bottom-line



You must monitor your intake of information very carefully. If you fill your mind with positive information, like this manual and similar information, you will produce positive results. You can take control of your thoughts by first taking control of the things that you allow to enter your mind.



If your goal is to run a four-minute mile, like Roger Bannister first did, the majority of your thoughts while training should be consistent with your goal.

It is impossible to think a negative thought while thinking of a positive thought. Looking at your written goals is one of the most effective ways to monitor your intake of information.

Look at your written goals as often as possible. Since the conscious mind can only hold one thought at a time, it is mentally and physically impossible for your mind to be dwelling on anything that is not consistent with your goals, when you are studying your goals.

Brian Tracy
Millionaire coach

Doctors and scientists told Bannister that it was impossible to run a four-minute mile. They said that a person would die in an attempt. Roger then proceeded to accomplish the goal of a four-minute mile. After Roger did it, hundreds of runners have accomplished the 'impossible.'

Roger Bannister had an unshakable desire to run a four-minute mile. He had a positive thought pattern and he looked at his goals often. Roger Bannister broke the four-minute barrier.

Do not allow negative thoughts to sway you off track. Only you know the physical limitations of your body. Others do not. Negative thoughts seem as though they are inevitable because a negative TV and media bombard us with 'garbage.' Everyday.

When you learn how to take control of your thoughts (your conscious mind), you will be able to apply this to your subconscious, and conquer any problems or difficulties. Napoleon Hill studied over 500 of the most productive people this planet has ever seen. He wrote about the way they used their minds to persuade themselves to long-lasting success in his book, Succeed and Grow Rich Through Persuasion,

"The power of thought is the most dangerous, or the most beneficial, power available to man, depending of course on how it is used."

What this means is that you are able to co-operate with your sub-conscious mind in a productive way toward the accomplishment of your goals. You can control your habits and make them work for you:

- You can improve upon your stride length;
- You can improve your swing to generate those valuable extra yards;
- You can improve your confidence level in pressure situations;
- You can increase your vertical jump;
- You can continually increase how many basketball free throws you shoot in a row.
- You can get better at whatever you set your mind to.

Law of Substitution

Negative thoughts are a fact of life. I hope a time comes when there is a person on this planet who can teach us how to eliminate limiting self-defeating thoughts from ever returning. While this is probably not altogether possible at this time, we *can* stop negative thoughts as they arise from expanding and doing any damage in our life; which is the next best thing.



The Law of Substitution says that you can substitute a positive thought for a negative one. As a negative thought arises, become aware of it and notice that it is a thought that is inconsistent with your goal.

Immediately give the command '*cancel*' to your subconscious mind. By telling your SCM to '*cancel*' the negative thought, you have stopped it in its tracks before it is allowed to flourish and bring an undesirable command to be carried out.

Once you've cancelled the negative thought, you can substitute a positive thought in its place. For example, when a negative arises, such as:

"I never capitalize on poorly thrown passes from the other quarterback."

Take these steps to apply the **Law of Substitution**:

1. Command the subconscious to *"Cancel! All negative thoughts are instantly dissolved!"* This stops the negative self-limiting thought from turning into a picture that would command the SCM to act on the negative outcome.
2. Give the subconscious a fresh positive command. *"I am confident and am able to capitalize on all opportunities on the football field!"* This command will keep the SCM alert and aware of opportunities.

Negative thoughts do not need to control your life. You own your mind. And you have complete control over it. Take ownership. Use it pro-actively to reach your training goals.

The Law of the Coach – *The coach lives in a goldfish bowl*

As a coach all eyes are on you. You are the leader, and you are always being tested. And everyone is watching how you will respond to the test.

Little league Moms. High school Dads. College parents. Semi-professional athlete's wives. Professional athletes. You name it. All eyes are on you.

They are waiting for you to fail
Because everyone is looking for an excuse.

To cope with this you must have an above average attitude. Everything is a test. If you win or if you lose, everyone is waiting to see how you will re-act ... because you're the leader.



If you want your team to have a winning attitude, YOU must first have one. Always. Regardless of the circumstances. You are the leader of your team. A good attitude must start with you.

Whether you realize it or not, you live in a goldfish bowl. Your athletes, their parents, wives, kids, etc., are watching every step you take. You must live beyond their expectations. If you don't, your team will be unsuccessful regardless of your win-loss record. And you will lose respect.

Ask yourself, "*How do I respond to a crisis?*"

You are the leader. Act like it. Always. Never let them see you slip. If you do have a momentary slip, shake it off with a good attitude and make sure your players see the way you handle a negative situation. Because they will handle it exactly the way you do. It's a law. **The Law of the Coach**. They will act just like you. Be their leader, because it is your job.

As a coach it is your job to find the positive in every situation. Find it ... only if you want your team to do the same thing. If you don't ... be negative. Because they will be like you, that is THEIR job.

Consistent, positive thoughts among the players on your team (cause) is at the root of creating the third and greater mind (TeamMastermind) that will lead your team to success (effect) on the football field, tennis court, on the ice or on the track. It starts with you – the coach and/or team leader.

A Crisis?

*"Our greatest glory was not in never falling,
but in rising when we fell."*

—Vince Lombardi



All negative happenings can be labeled as a crisis. Negatives happen, they happen all day long to one degree or another. It's called life. How you respond to a crisis (a negative) will determine your success in life.

All crises, on the field, in the gym, or in the pool, are nothing more than a crisis of your thought process. Because there is always a positive.

Can you change your thought? Yes! When you are in the middle of a 'crisis,' relax and quickly evaluate the situation. You can change your thought with the Law of Substitution. You now know how to stay in control in virtually any crisis. Because you are in control of your conscious thought.

To follow is a quote of a top college coach who did not respond well to some adversities that affected his team. This is a real recording of a real coach. He is the leader of a top college, 'inspiring his troops' to action in a large game. This is an example of how NOT to be the leader of an organization. Ask yourself, *"Would you pour your heart into a game, playing for an individual who would re-act like this?"*

This coach destroyed any possibilities for his team to ever create the **TeamMastermind**. *Can you think of any truly great coaches, or teachers who would re-act like this?* Bill Walsh, former coach of the San Francisco 49ers is a person who inspired his team to greatness by being a master of his emotions. He always acted like the professional that he is. And especially among the small crises that happen every single day.

Walsh never showed failure emotions in front of his team. His players wanted to play for him. Good coaches can be the 'catalyst' to bring a team to greatness. A bad coach can be the catalyst for failure.

The actions of this coach merely stem from a habit of cracking under pressure:

*" If you don't want to play, then I'm getting the f*** out of here! If you aren't gonna cover [him], if, you're gonna let him just drive right by 'ya ... without one guy challenging him, then I'm leaving and you f***ing guys can run 'till 'ya can't eat supper! I'm tired of this sh**! I'm sick and f***in' tired of an eight and ten record! I'm f***in' tired of losin' to [Rival Organization] ... this is absolute f***ing bullsh**! I'll f***in' run you're *ss into the ground! You'll think last night was a f***in' picknick! You better get your head out of your *ss!"*

The secret to turning every crisis into a winning situation is to find the positive. If you look, you can find a positive in every situation.

Finding the positive is nothing more than a change of thought. Which will become a habit by applying the slight-edge principle and the Law of 21. Decide right now to find the positive in every 'crisis.'

Accentuate the Positive

By Dr. Joseph Parent

TeamMastermind Mental Strength coach

Email: Win@TeamMastermind.com

Dr. Parent specializes in Mental Game Mastery for Sports, Business, and Life. Although this article is written for a golfer, it is relevant towards all athletics.

"Ask yourself how many shots you would have saved if you never got down on yourself, never lost your temper, always developed a strategy before you hit, and always played within your capabilities."

- Jack Nicklaus
Golf Champion

The mental skills necessary to play your best golf need to be learned and grooved, no different than developing good swing techniques. Proper mental habits must be ingrained in order to achieve your best performance.

One of the most unhelpful habits is the tendency to focus on the negative, which needs to be replaced with the habit of focusing on the positive. A brief conversation I had with a touring pro provides a good example of this point.

After the first round of the tournament I asked him how the day went. He said, "I played o.k., more or less. I had one hole where I chose the wrong club and made double-bogey." He said it as if he'd come in at more than one or two over par.

Later that day I was looking at the scoreboard and was completely surprised when I saw his hole-by-hole score. In our conversation he had neglected to mention that he'd made an eagle and four birdies!

Mental Game Challenge

So often we focus on the negative and disregard the positive. This is perhaps the most common unhelpful attitude among golfers (and people in general). The mistakes are what stand out in our minds, what we remember. This adds to the pressure we feel and undermines our confidence.

In all too many cases we're our own worst critics. Finding something wrong in almost every shot, or situation. Even the ones that produce very good results.

We have some idea (probably ones we've had most of our lives) that if we don't make a big deal about a mistake we've made we'll never learn from it. And when we do well, that's what's expected, so it doesn't get much attention. We usually don't get excited about making a four-foot put, but we get very upset about missing one.

Because of the added emphasis we put on negative events, they become more prominent in our memory. It's been said that golfers get more nervous about short putts as their careers go on because they've accumulated too many memories of the one's they've missed!

Mental Game Solution

This is a simple problem, but not an easy one to correct because it is such a strong habit. It takes practice to break habits (see The Law of 21 - on page 61). The first step is awareness. Pay attention to what you say about your performance, to others and to yourself.

You'll probably be surprised at how often you have a negative comment in your mind. You need to find something good about every shot and every round. You need to change the habit of finding the negative. You must let go of the errors, and dwell on the successes.

You need to have a short memory for bad shots and a long memory for good ones.

- Jonny Miller

Take time to appreciate a good shot as it flies to the target and settles down just where you planned. This will imprint a positive image in your mind, and build your confidence. After each round, spend a few minutes reviewing the good decisions and the good shots you made.

Perhaps the most important point is to give yourself a break when things don't go well. If you were with a friend who was having a bad time, you wouldn't call him names, criticize him, and make him feel bad. You would be supportive.

You'd tell him that everyone has a bad hole or even a bad day. And you'd tell him that he'll do better next time. So be a friend to yourself, and give yourself the same type of encouragement!

The following is the most important chapter that you will ever read. Please read it several times. Feel free to email Training@RealAthlete.com with questions or insights.

+++++

"From the time we step onto the football field, tennis court, or gymnast floor, our entire existence becomes a chain of semi-instinctive acts (habits), acquired from the previous hours of training and competition."

– Samuel F. Hirschberg
TeamMastermind

Law of Habit – Habits are stored inside your subconscious

The definition of a habit is any activity so well established that it occurs without thought.

Do you have?

- The habit of winning
- The habit of hitting first serves in tennis
- The habit of catching the football or baseball
- The habit of outmaneuvering the offensive line
- The habit of successfully goaltending under pressure
- The habit of hitting crosscourt and down-the-line forehands on the run
- The habit of 'seeing' where the puck is going on the ice
- The habit of persistence
- The habit of being mentally tough?



Everything we do is automatic. We have habits that have been ingrained in us since our conception. If it weren't for habits, our time would be occupied by thinking about how to do simple things like walk, run, and jump.

Habits free us from having to re-learn the basic skills that we rely on daily, every time we set foot on the playing field.

In Michael Murphy's book, In The Zone, he, and his co-author relate a story of former heavyweight boxing champion Ingemar Johansson. Ingemar recalls the power of his right hand delivering the knock out punch,

“...it worked independently of his conscious mind and was so fast even he couldn't see it.

‘Without my telling it to, the right goes’...”

Doing things automatically, such as correctly swinging a baseball bat or throwing a perfect 10-yard pass, saves us a tremendous amount of energy and time. Your SCM controls all your ‘involuntary’ habits as well as your ‘voluntary’ habits simultaneously. Your SCM controls all these things that we sometimes take for granted;

- Your breathing
- Your running stride length
- Jumping ease and height
- Heart rate
- Seeing the ‘obvious’ flaws of your competitors
- Peripheral vision
- Your senses
- And much, much more; all while competing

The power of your subconscious can be put to work for you. In his book, The Power of the Subconscious, Dr. Joseph Murphy said,

“When your conscious mind and sub-conscious mind are no longer quarreling, you will get exactly what you desire.”

Your mind belongs to you exclusively. Take possession of it. Direct it to your specific use and make your sporting activity payoff on your terms. Create your own habits and re-actions. This is how you put your subconscious on automatic pilot. This is what will help your body to move with the same ‘flowing’ sensation as water.

The subconscious mind is home of the automatic pilot that every athlete hopes for in competition. Olympic Gold medallist Lanny

Basham writes in his book, With Winning in Mind, about his career as a rifle sharpshooter:

A rifle shooter who has subconscious trigger control will activate the trigger when the sights are aligned. A shooter who consciously activates the trigger will most probably move the rifle as he shoots, thereby throwing the shot off.

You literally are a product of every bit of information that has ever been put into your mind.

Every part of your life lies within your SCM. Information goes into your conscious mind. Then, much like a bridge across a river, that information is put into your subconscious mind.



You have control over much of the programming of your subconscious mind. But, in many situations, information goes directly into your SCM without the aid of your conscious. This is what is commonly referred to as a subliminal activity.

Programming Your Subconscious (SCM)

Please read these points several times:

- The subconscious mind may be voluntarily directed to do what you want it to do only through your habits.
- Your habits begin in the form of a thought.
- Your conscious mind creates your thoughts.
- When you are able to control your thoughts, you are able to control your imagination.
- Your thoughts and imagination (visualization) will lead your subconscious mind to successful habit patterns.
- This is why correct visualization is so important to your success.



Your SCM is most susceptible to thought mixed with emotion. Much more so than by thoughts created solely by the conscious mind. Put the emotions to work for you. There are seven major positive emotions and seven major negative emotions.



Emotions can be used for your purposes when you are familiar with them. You have to learn to control them. If you don't control them, negative emotions will automatically control you. They will inject themselves directly into your subconscious.

Feeling impulses, or emotions, are like yeast in a loaf of bread. They constitute the action element. If you do not use the positive emotions for your own good, negative emotions are automatically used in place of the positive ones.

The seven major positive emotions:

- Desire
- Faith
- Love
- Sex
- Enthusiasm
- Romance
- Hope

The seven major negative emotions (to be avoided):

- Fear
- Jealousy
- Hatred
- Revenge
- Greed
- Superstition
- Anger

It is physically and mentally impossible for a positive and negative emotion to occupy a thought in the mind at the same time. This is another reason to be focused on your goal at all times.

Negative emotions voluntarily inject themselves into your thoughts during training or competition.

The seven negative emotions are powerful. Powerfully negative. Negative emotion pollutes your blood. Chemicals are released. This 'chemically treated blood' could virtually kill small animals if injected into them. This is probably why the life span of humans that react to stress poorly is much shorter than those that

react to stress in a positive way (the trick is to find the positive in every crisis).

It is incredibly important to your success that you become familiar with these emotions – good and bad – and learn to control them.

Positive and Negative Habits

In most cases, the word habit conjures feelings of negativity, probably because people first think of the bad habits that plague their life. We frequently have very talented tennis players come to us and ask for help on their service swing. What we find are that many players acquire a “hitch,” or “shank” in their swings.

For example, compare the service swing of Pete Sampras and Brad Gilbert. Both of these players have reached phenomenal success in the game of tennis. Sampras has a free flowing swing that enables him to generate peak momentum and generate a natural hip and shoulder rotation.

On the other hand, Gilbert had acquired a rather limiting hitch in his service swing, which caused him to lose maximum hip and shoulder rotation. Because of this, he was forced to make up for the loss of service power in other areas of his tennis game.



This self-made hindrance is nothing more than a movement or lack of movement (controlled by the subconscious) in the middle of the service motion (or any athletic movement for that matter). More often than not, this hitch causes an athlete to inhibit their potential.

In sports, this is an example of acquiring a bad habit (if it is holding you back from higher levels of success). A hitch in your swing can be fixed. Assuming there are no physical limitations to hold you back (which may be the cause of Brad Gilbert's hitch).

The definition of a habit is any activity so well established that it occurs without thought on the part of an individual.

The definition of a good habit is a habit that is helping you achieve your goal (s). The definition of a bad habit is one that is pulling you away from your goal (s).



All long-lasting achievement is the result of productive habits. Habits that are consistent with your goal. Napoleon Hill typifies the peak achiever in athletics with this statement about the successful person who is willing to do what it takes to succeed:

It is the rarest sort of experience to find a person anywhere, at anytime, who lives his own life, thinks his own thoughts, develops his own habits, and makes even the slightest attempt to be himself ... Once in a while a person will pull away from the crowd, and think his own thoughts that are congruent with his goals, dreams, and livelihood, and dare to be himself.



Our entire life is filled with good and bad habits. From the time we step onto the football field, tennis court, or gymnast floor, our entire existence becomes a chain of semi-instinctive acts (habits).

- Basketball superstar Michael Jordan practiced his jumps up to 1000 times per day. He made performing effective jumps on the basketball court a habit.
- Legendary American hurdler Edwin Moses won 117 out of 119 races. He made winning a habit.
- Olympic Gold medallist speed skater Dan Jansen was wrought with setback after setback. He attempted to medal in four (16 years) Olympic games. He came up short each year. In his least favorite event, the 1000-meter sprint, in his last opportunity in the Olympic games, he plummeted the world record. And won the Gold medal. He made enduring and persisting a habit.

The outstandingly good news is that your habits are entirely under your control. Look at other peak athletes. How is it that Olympic swimmer Matt Biondi, 38-year-old NFL linebacker Sam Mills, and the 30-year-old women's tennis player Steffi Graf get past their physical and mental setbacks (everyone has setbacks, champions learn how to adapt and deal with them) and dominate their field of endeavor for such a long period of time?



Habits are your master key to success. Good habits are the result of good thoughts. Habits are completely positive, if you control them. Yet they can be devastating if you allow them to control you. In the cases of the above athletes, good habits are the difference between success and failure. Good habits are your key to mental strength.

Programming Your Re-Actions and the Peak Performance Zone



Within your habits are your actions (and re-actions) to a stimulus. This is very important. Inside of each habit is the source for optimal performance. Michael Chang is one of the best counter-punchers in the game of tennis. This means that he is able to re-act to the tennis ball with extreme effectiveness.

Because of his tremendous speed (a variation of one of the basics; balance) he is able to do this with excellence. He has made a good habit out of his ability to re-act.

When Chang's mind slips into the peak performance zone, he is operating solely on his ability to act and re-act.



Because of this, it is very difficult for a person to out maneuver him. When your mind slips into the zone, you are operating solely on *your* ability to act and re-act. Your ability to act and re-act in your sport is a result of your habits.

Operating in the peak performance zone is a function of your subconscious mind,



The Peak Performance Zone
Is a point of subconscious re-action and
It is a point of habitual action (your habits).

It is stated this way because you have full control over your habits, although you do not always have full control over your re-actions. When you have the two working in harmony, like Michael Chang, you have laid in the groundwork for peak achievement inside the zone.

Here are examples of two types of re-actions. The first type of habitual re-action, which we do not always have full control over, is the type that if we did not re-act we would be causing ourselves bodily harm. This would primarily be against one of the elements – earth, wind, fire, or water. A simple example of this is when you pull your hand away from a flame on the stove; you are re-acting to the flame.



Joe Hyams, author of Zen in the Martial Arts, explains another type of habitual re-acting. This is the only type of re-acting we will refer to while discussing mental strength. These are the re-actions that you have full control over as a result (effect) of your training (cause). Hyams is here referring to a young Aikido master that he witnessed during an exhibition of his talent:

He looked fragile and vulnerable as he faced half-a-dozen burly men who circled him menacingly. As they began to close in on him, the master remained still, calm, and poised, standing in the eye of the hurricane. Suddenly with loud shouts they attacked him in unison.

What happened then was magnificent. The master seemed to flow like water into the mass. Swirling between them, his black skirt seemed to surround them. Every time they reached to strike his body, it was not there. As a gyroscope spins faster and faster, its motion appears calm; so it was with the master as he diverted the energy of his attackers.



This Aikido master trained himself to re-act to each stimulus that was thrown his way from the acquisition of productive habits. He unconsciously acted to fend off the men attacking him. He acquired the basic skills that gave him the ability to do this, just as you would require the basic skills to play in the NFL or the NBA. In order to reach maximum effectiveness while in the zone, your basic skills must be at a level to re-act properly.

Consciousness is not reactivity. Reactivity is an unconscious (subconscious) reaction to a stimuli.

Dr. Eldon Taylor



In order for your subconscious mind to enter *the zone*, it requires your conscious mind to be uninvolved with the process, and solely fixed upon the present moment. If the Aikido master had said to himself, "*Uh-oh, what if I can't beat these six guys?*" He could be giving his inner computer a visual command. That is assuming he wasn't able to '*cancel!*' the negative thought immediately.

Remember, the job of the inner computer (SCM) is to do what it is told by the programmer (conscious mind); nothing more, nothing less. Whether it be a positive or a negative command. In this scenario, the subconscious mind says, "*Let's see what happens when we don't beat these guys.*" The subconscious mind then does everything it can do to fulfill this 'self-fulfilling prophecy.'

He could say, "*I'm going to relax my mind and let my good habits take over.*" "*I am qualified to beat these six guys.*" In this scenario he is giving his subconscious a positive command. At the same time, he has trained himself to focus his conscious mind on the present moment. Although it is surprisingly simple, this is the difficult task for most athletes. The problem seems to be that simple does not equate to easy.

Some of our work is done with people to expose them to the fact that they do have more control than they think over their 'involuntary' body functions, like breathing or heart rate. It has been found that for most sports, optimal performance requires your heart rate to be under 150 beats per minute.

You have at least an 80% chance of losing if you compete with a heart rate over 150 beats per minute.

Being able to relax in competition is critical. This is much easier than you may think. It is solely up to you to develop the skill. No one can slow your heart rate or breathing pattern for you. Nor would you want anyone to do it for you.

You do not have to be an Indian Yogi to be able to control your body. It is your body and you have full control over it. Your subconscious mind does what it is told to do by your conscious mind. When you have developed the habit of staying calm, poised, and relaxed by controlling your breathing and heart rate, like the Aikido master discussed earlier, you will be able to rely solely on your habits and reactions when you enter the zone.

The Slight-Edge Principle



Every thought counts. Every thought helps ... or ... every thought hurts. There are no in-betweens. As an athlete you can either have positive, success-producing thoughts, or you can have negative, failure-producing thoughts. Your most predominant thoughts – positive or negative – will determine whether you have a positive outlook on life, or a negative outlook.

"Thoughts are things."

–Dr. Wayne Dyer

All thoughts are stored in your subconscious. A thought that is repeated is accepted by your SCM. When a thought is totally accepted by your subconscious, you have produced either a limiting habit (from a negative thought) or an empowering habit (from a positive thought). Thoughts are the beginning of all habits. It's your choice.

Success coach Brian Tracy said in his audiotape course, The Universal Laws of Success,

"Good habits are hard to form but easy to live with while bad habits are easy to form but hard to live with."



Acquiring a habit that is consistent with an athletic goal is the single most important skill you can ever attain. Habits free us from having to waste mental and physical energy on making repetitive decisions.

The Bottom Line

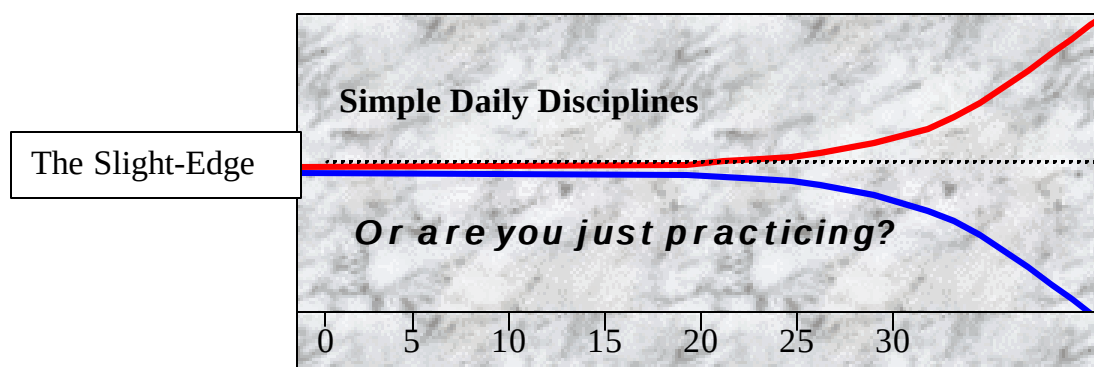
The difference between a successful habit and a failure producing habit is very slight. The difference can be a simple change of thought.

The slight-edge principle says that over a period of time you will experience success if you practice simple daily disciplines. Simple is defined as something that you can do, even if it may be something you do not necessarily like to do.

You have two choices with the slight-edge principle. You can make the slight-edge work for you, or, it **will** work against you;

1. Practice simple daily disciplines that are consistent with your goals
2. Or, the slight-edge will work against you, producing negative results over a period of time (usually by allowing the law of input to work against you).

Are you practicing the slight-edge in your life?

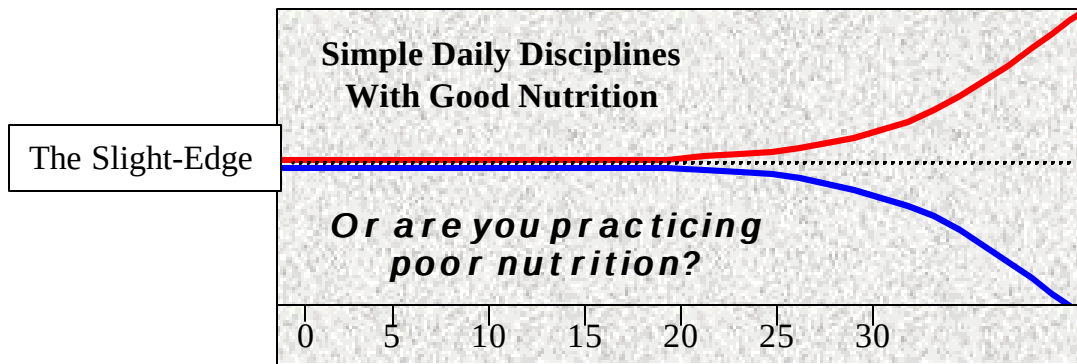


As an example, *TeamMastermind* works with many athletes who do not have the slightest idea of what kinds of food to eat, or, when they should eat. This is a great example of developing the slight-edge. Let's apply the slight-edge to your eating habits:



Most people eat foods that are high in simple sugars, thinking they will have enough energy for a 90 minute training session (i.e., candy bar, high sugar fruits, sodas, etc.). The effect of a decision like this is that these foods will not give you enough energy to last your training period. Learning some simple rules about foods; what to eat and when to eat, can give you the slight-edge you are looking for. Once you are consciously aware of this, you can create the habit and make proper eating an unconscious decision.

Are you practicing the slight-edge with your eating habits?



The Law of 21

Habits keep you from making repetitive decisions. They keep your conscious mind from messing up the process – habits make the process automatic.

- The **Law of 21** is probably the most important law that you have in your arsenal of training techniques.
- When implemented correctly with a coach, mentor, or trainer, you can improve, alter, or build from anew any habit or re-action that you want.
- The **Law of 21** is the 'mother of all skills' when beginning a new action – or replacing old habits for fresh, new habits.



Your habits and re-actions are molded only by repetition. When you do something again and again, you will make it a habit. **The Law of 21** says that if you do anything 21 times without interrupting the process by doing the movement another way, and you continue this process, you have laid the necessary foundation for a habit.

"It is the rarest sort of experience to find a person anywhere, at anytime, who lives his own life, thinks his own thoughts, develops his own habits..."

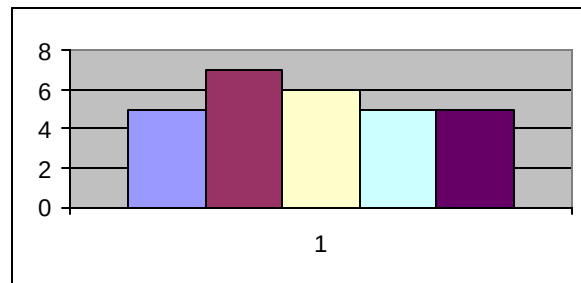
—Napoleon Hill

Being a USPTA tennis professional, and strength-and-fitness coach, TeamMastermind coach Sam Hirschberg works with many athletes of all skill levels and abilities. He says, "With the Law of 21 in my arsenal, I am able to work with anyone desiring better results, whether on the tennis court, or weight-training in the gym."

Ask your clients to take out a piece of paper. Draw this graph, and ask the athlete to label themselves on a scale of 1-10.

"How do feel about each pillar of the Pentagon of Strength?"

Limit–Speed–Anaerobic–Aerobic–Mental



This is an example of a sprinter that RealAthlete works with. Heather is a high school sprinter whose greatest strength is her speed strength. She first labeled her speed strength as a 7. From a seven being the highest, she then thought that her anaerobic strength was the next highest as she thought that was a 6, as it compares to her speed strength. She then thought that her limit, aerobic, and mental strength deserved a 5 in comparison to her other strengths.

When they label themselves, remember that they know their bodies better than anyone else does. When this question is asked, the real answer usually comes out in the first 20 seconds. Tell them to trust their answers. Their subconscious will bring out the right answer, once it is asked. These answers, and any tests you may do (weightlifting, wind sprints, 1-mile run, medicine ball, etc.) will give you the foundation to work from.

Once you have discovered your weaknesses (which are weaknesses in your self-concept) you can now apply your training methods (a combination between mental and physical training) to increase your self-concept and physical abilities. The answer to getting better always lies in your self-concept.

Focused Repetition

Implementing the **Law of 21** with your mental and physical training can give you the slight-edge over your competition. Using the Law of 21 toward your training can reinforce the good habits, and replace the bad.



The Law of 21 says that whatever specific activity you do 21 times repeatedly, you will lay in the foundation for this specific activity. It is going into your SCM so that eventually you can do it without thinking.

In order to be automatic your subconscious mind must be able to take over completely. Use the Law of 21 as a simple guideline to master a specific technique that you would like to make automatic.

We work with several athletes of all different sports that want to replace self-made 'hitches' with a good habit that could enhance their skills. In tennis, how you use your left hand can be critical to your success. One particular student, Ryan, was desperately trying to generate more power on his forehand.

After noticing how he generated power, it was relatively easy to help him incorporate the use of his left hand. In tennis, like many other sports, power is generated from shoulder and trunk rotation – abdominals and lower back (which can be increased by focusing on a combination of limit strength and speed strength).

With minimal rotation of the shoulders and trunk, Ryan was incorporating very little body movement when hitting forehands. This caused him to use his arm and racquet momentum to generate much of the power.

One common technique we use to help a player create the habit of trunk rotation, is the habit of using the left hand (left hand for right handed players, right hand for left handed players). I took Ryan through some simple training methods (the same one you now have), teaching him to incorporate mental and physical training to ingrain this new habit. We showed him how to keep his left hand on the throat of his racquet for a bit longer when turning to hit a forehand. This causes him to turn his left shoulder with the racquet head to generate more rotation.



When you have located a flaw or an area that can be improved upon, you can apply the Law of 21 towards developing your basic skills, developing good nutritional habits, weight-training goals, or to any goal you desire.

The Law of 21 is your secret to developing any habit that you want. You can remove an annoying, energy-expending 'hitch' from your life. Apply the Law of 21 to create the habit that you would like.

Law of the Comfort Zone

... the key to success is to operate outside of your comfort zone ...

—Brian Tracy

“Do you wonder why you’re stuck in that slump?”

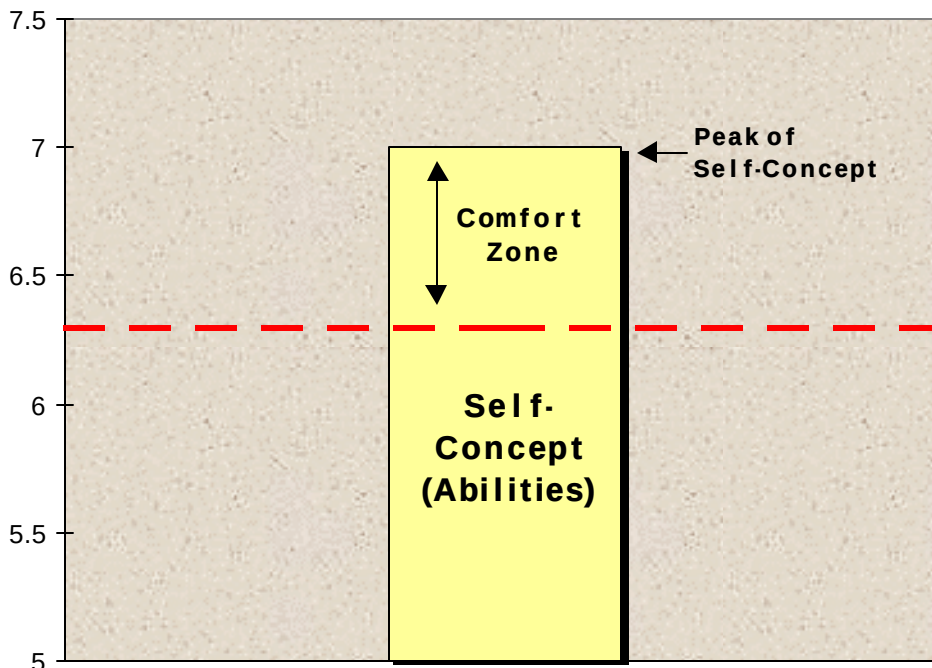


Have you ever wondered why you are at the “*bottom of your game, in a seemingly endless slump?*” And you just aren’t able to play ‘up to par’ as you normally do? The answer lies beneath your self-concept. It is called the comfort zone, a window somewhere within your self-concept.

Your self-concept controls your actions. It dictates everything that you do. The self-concept is the foundation of your **comfort zone**. And your mental toughness.

Your comfort zone is located within your self-concept. When you are operating in the window of the ‘comfort zone,’ you will be operating in a zone that is below your best. The best being the peak of your self-concept.

You could be making careless mistakes when you are stuck in this



zone. You’ll be annoyed easily. And you’ll show signs of a lack of concentration. I’m sure every athlete can relate to the

comfort zone. When you are in the comfort zone, your conscious mind is 'thinking too much.' This can happen for several reasons.

At any point during your training or competition, your mind will be in one of two places:

- 1.) Comfort Zone – playing *below* the peak of your self-concept;
- 2.) Peak Performance Zone – playing in the window 10% above the level of your self-concept.

When you are in the comfort zone, your mind will be thinking about one of two things:

- 1.) Some past occurrence. You could be thinking about statements such as,
 - *"What if I drop the ball like I did last Saturday?"*
 - *"What if my back foot catches the 4th hurdle the way it did in practice on Thursday?"*
 - *"I hope I play like last Tuesday, if I do, I will be undefeated."*
- 2.) A future possibility. You could be thinking statements like,
 - *"If I win this point, I will be up by two – when that happens, I can't lose!"*
 - *"If I hit the ball crosscourt, she'll never be able to get to it, then I'll win the point."*
 - *"Don't drop the ball you dummy, you'll look really dumb!"*

All the above are thoughts. They can create pictures, pictures that have emotions. And you will probably act on those emotions. Whether they are positive or negative. Be careful of what you think about.



If you think about the past or the future (cause), you will be in your comfort zone (effect). By being in your comfort zone, you could be making careless mistakes, or playing like a player who *"isn't as good as I am,"* or worse yet, losing to a player who *"isn't as good as I am."* We know that you have been there. Everybody has.

Everyone has been in his or her comfort zone, just as everyone has been in his or her peak performance zone. The majority of athletes spend a greater amount of time in their comfort zone rather than where they belong, in their peak performance zone.

“The greatest athletes have made competing in their peak performance zone a habit. Which causes them to continually learn and achieve new heights.”

-TeamMastermind.com

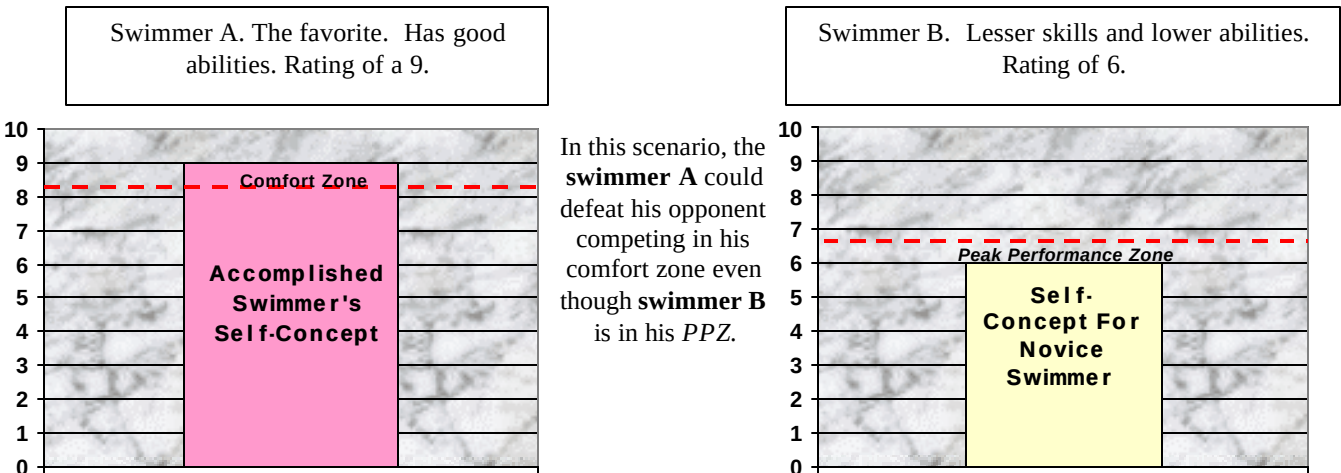


In most cases, if an athlete has a very developed game, he or she will have a high self-concept. If you are an excellent athlete, you may be able to compete in your comfort zone and still produce the results you want. Many athletes are able to do this. This happens because your self-concept is much higher than the competition.

Maybe you are a competing swimmer in the prelims. There are probably several swimmers that have a lower self-concept than you. And you must compete against them in preliminary races. In this case, competing in your comfort zone would be OK, because your comfort zone is much higher than many swimmers' peak performance zone.

Possible problems could occur when the competition is equal, or even if you are slightly better. If you are competing in your comfort zone and your competition is in his or her peak performance zone, you could be edged-out of the competition. Even though you were favored to win.

For this example we will call the comfort zone 10% below the peak of your self-concept. Although your comfort zone could be anywhere below the peak of your self-concept:



Everything you do will produce a result for you. Every thought that you hold will produce a result. It's perfectly normal to be talking to yourself. To become the best that you can become you must learn how to think in a way that will achieve maximum results.

Statements like the previous ones are not going to help you achieve maximum results. To achieve peak results, apply the law of the peak performance zone with the previous laws that you have learned.

The Law of the Peak Performance Zone

"How can you hit and think at the same time?"

Yogi Berra

All great achievers have learned how to consistently stay out of the comfort zone and put themselves into their peak performance zone. The Peak Performance Zone is very misunderstood in the world of sports. When an accomplished athlete reaches this zone, he or she can create magic.

You've probably heard it said that on the ATP professional tennis tour, anyone in the top 100 could beat any other player, on any given day (this can occur in any sport). *Have you ever asked yourself why this is?*

How come an athlete ranked 100 can beat an athlete ranked in the top 5?

All the players in the top 100 (example) have developed their skills to a very high level. They all have very high confidence, belief, and a high self-concept for their skills and athletic ability.



If one player is playing more points in their comfort zone and the other player is playing more points in his or her peak performance zone; the player in his or her peak performance zone will win. That is being mentally tough.

This is how an 'unexplained' upset can happen. For this reason, you should have two main priorities when you are in competition:

- 1.) Play in your peak performance zone
- 2.) Keep your opponent in his or her comfort zone

Players like John McEnroe, Ilie Nastase, and Jimmy Connors were masters of making the other player think. Through their common outbursts, you'll notice they rarely spoke negative things about themselves. They usually

created a scene that made the other player think, causing him to come out of their peak performance zone.



The peak performance zone is an activity of the subconscious mind. When the conscious mind is not thinking in the process, the subconscious mind will be operating with the skills and habits that have been developed – because of the self-concept.

The peak performance zone can be reached by keeping your mind focused on the present moment. At one time, Billie Jean King was the coach of women's tennis phenomena Martina Navratilova. King had Navratilova concentrate on colorful wallpaper to put her mind in the habit of being focused on the present moment. Many martial artists focus on their breathing patterns to find the present moment.

When you relax and find the present moment, you will be relying on your self-concept and habit patterns to guide you to success.

Finding the present moment

Here are some methods taught by TeamMastermind to help you locate the present moment during your training and competition. There are as many ways to locate the present moment as there are people living in the U.S. Maybe more. Please try to locate your most effective method – the one that you can rely upon.

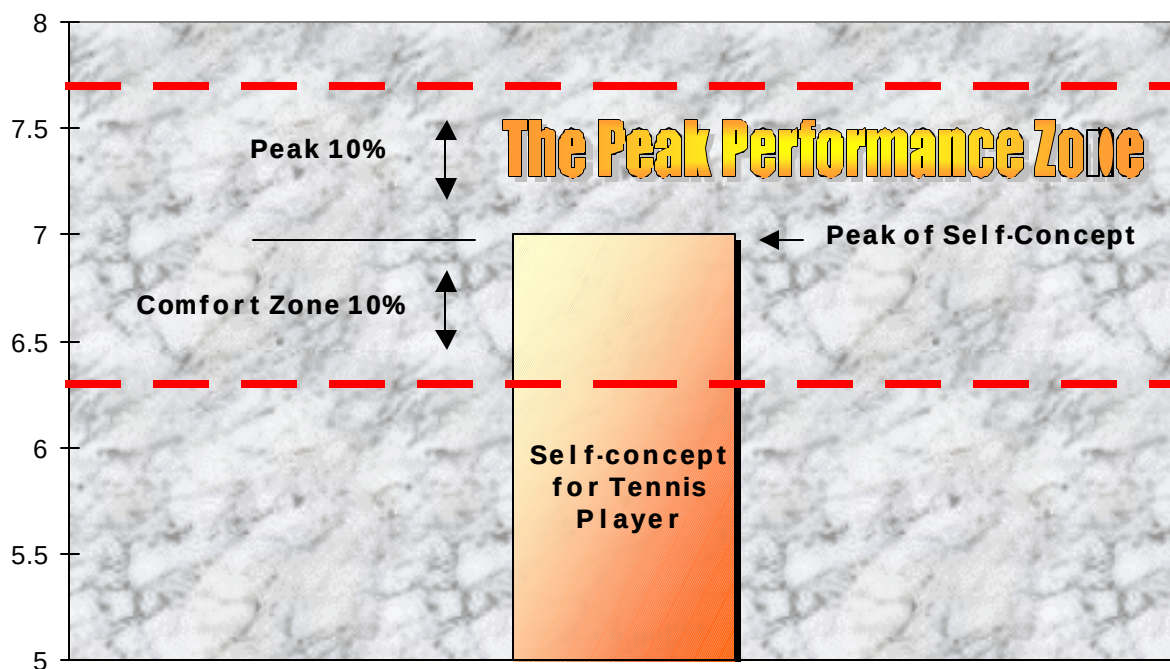
- Concentrate on your breathing
- Focus on the rotation of the ball
- Put your mind solely on your footwork
- Listen to the air filling your lungs
- Feel the air leaving your lungs
- See the threads of the football

Golf pro Tony Jacklin describes the moment in which he is in his peak performance zone;

"When I'm in this state, this cocoon of concentration, I'm living fully in the present, not moving out of it. I'm aware of every half inch of my swing. I'm absolutely engaged, involved in what I'm doing at that particular moment."

The bottom line

- The comfort zone says that you will perform within a window below the level of your self-concept.
- The peak performance zone says that you will perform



within a window 10% above the level of your self-concept.

The player above has a self-concept for the game of tennis of 7.0

- Ten percent of seven is $1/7$ or 0.7
- This player's comfort zone is between 6.3 and 7.0 (anywhere in self-concept)
- He will never be able to peak his game at any time to a level above 10% of his self-concept. In this scenario, he will never be able to peak above a 7.7
- 7.7 is at the top of his Peak Performance Zone
- The optimal zone for this player is between 7.0 and 7.7
- This is his peak performance zone (in the Zone). The best that he could ever play. Until of course, he trains to raise his self-concept.



If he is competing against a player who is at the same level, problems can arise when he is playing below his self-concept, between 6.3 and 7.0, or below (in the majority of cases 'thinking too much'). When this occurs, it opens a huge window of opportunity for his opponent to play in his peak zone, playing somewhere above his self-concept (in the zone).

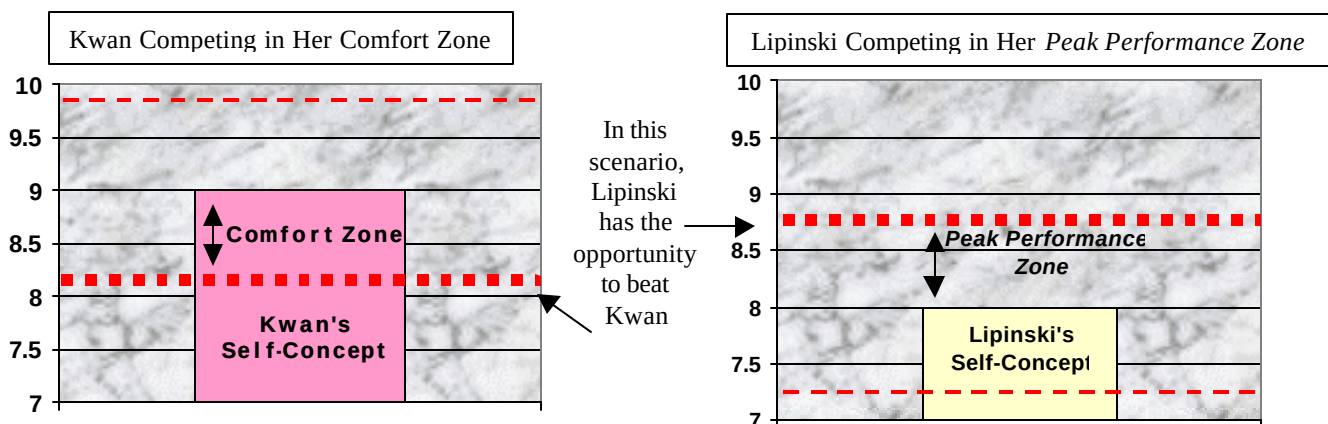
Here is an example of two Olympic figure skaters. This is purely an example; *TeamMastermind* has not done any work with either of these skaters. This is simply a possibility of what could have happened in the 1998 Olympic games in Nagano.

Olympic figure skater Michele Kwan may have an overall self-concept of a 9.0. Tara Lipinski may have a self-concept of an 8.0. In this example, Kwan's level of confidence and basics are at a higher level than of her "8.0" counterpart.

A problem can arise for Michele if she is not using these laws to her advantage. Equally devastating for Michele Kwan is when her opponent is a lesser skater and is using the law of the peak performance zone to her advantage.

Michele Kwan could be skating in her comfort zone:

- Self-concept = 9.0;
- $9.0 \times 10\% = 0.9$;
- $9.0 - 0.9 = 8.1$;
- **8.1** is at the bottom ten percent of Kwan's comfort zone



Lipinski could be skating in her peak performance zone:

- Self-concept = 8.0
- $8.0 \times 10\% = 0.8$
- $8.0 + 0.8 = 8.8$
- **8.8** is the peak of Lipinski's peak performance zone;

In this scenario, Lipinski has an opportunity to beat Kwan although Kwan may be a 'better' skater. This is what could have happened to give Lipinski the Gold medal in Nagano. *Can you do what Lipinski did? Can you operate in your peak performance zone?* Yes! You can.

These laws are probably the most misunderstood laws in the world of sports. Now you can see why professional or peak athletics can be 90% mental.

The bottom line

In competition, you always have two main objectives (goals)

- 1.) Perform in your peak zone
- 2.) Keep your opponent (s) in their comfort zone

With these concepts in your arsenal, peak mental strength is within your grasp. Once you understand these principles, they are yours to teach, to use, and to win competitions with.

http://www.MentalStrength.com



Athletes Helping Athletes Achieve the Slight-Edge

MentalStrength.com

Total Sports Success

Mental Strength Training Regimen

- The six steps to mastering any activity
- Testing your strength
- The nine steps to an unstoppable attitude
- The law of substitution
- Athletic laws and definitions

Your highest priority is always to increase your self-concept:



The six steps to mastering any habit or activity

- i. Set a specific area that you want to improve upon or accomplish** – a clear and specific goal
 - a. Write it down on a 3 x 5 card
 - b. Set a date for it to be accomplished
 - c. Write the date next to the goal
 - d. Make a detailed plan for its accomplishment
 - e. Carry the card with you every where you go
 - f. Look at it often
- ii. Accept 100% responsibility** for your actions and attitudes – understand that you are where you are and what you are because of you
- iii. Improve upon your basic skills**
 - a. Practice, practice, practice.
 - b. Apply the Law of 21 to your training
- iv. Affirmations**
 - a. Write down your affirmations on your goal card. See below for examples.
 - b. Train your mind 2-4 times per day by studying your affirmations. One time before bed. Another just after you wake up. More repetitions throughout the day when you are in a relaxed and uninterrupted state-of-mind.
 - c. Play one of the affirmation cassette tapes in the All Star Sports Performance program. For best results, use while you are sleeping. Put it on low volume and use an auto-reverse tape player.
- v. Visualizations**

Invest 20 (two 10 minute sessions) minutes to do 2 visualization sessions per day. The All Star Sports Performance program has four guided sessions for you. This will separate you from the pack. Go to www.TeamMastermind.com to the Performance link to choose the best cassette for your needs.
- vi. Act as if it were impossible to fail** – Always under the guidance of a good coach, trainer, or mentor.

Sample Training Program

Goal – To weigh 185 lbs., drop 18 lbs. of body mass.

Target Date: May 1

Daily Plan:

- Eat five meals a day, between 300-500 calories each meal
 - o Times per meal: 8:00am, 10:30am, 1:00pm, 4:00pm, and 7:00pm.
 - o Workout at either 11:00 – 12:00, or 2:00pm – 3:00pm.
- Cardiovascular training for 30 minutes a day.
 - o Train abdominals and lower back 3x/ week
- Drink 64 ounces water.
- 5-10 servings fruits/ veggies day.
- Eat low-glycemic index carbs.
- Eat lean protein, and protein shakes with small meals.

Affirmations:

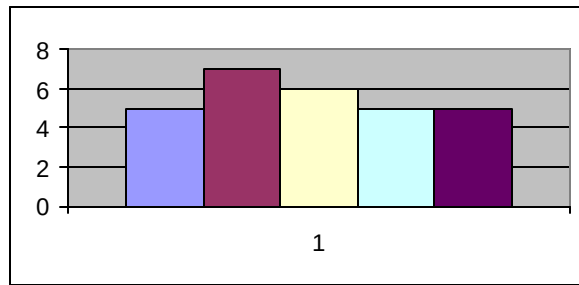
To be read and internalized 2 - 4 times per day, before and after sleep.

1. I am 100% responsible for reaching my weight goal of 185 lbs.
2. I am ecstatic to be reaching my weight training goals!
3. I weigh 185 lbs!
4. I eat only clean, life-enriching foods that help me reach my weight goal of 185 lbs.
5. I enjoy working in the gym to drop body mass.
6. Yes! My abdominal muscles are strong and visible.
7. My energy level is very high. I eat five or six small meals a day.
8. My body is lean, strong, and flexible.
9. Excess bodyfat is easily removed from my body.
10. Everyday my body is becoming healthier, stronger, and leaner.

Visualizations:

Do two 10-minute visualizations depicting exactly how you will think, feel and look at 185 lbs. Describe how will you compete, and move in your sport to the smallest detail. Order the ASSP cassette program, *Building strength, stamina, and muscle tone* for guided visualizations, and affirmations. This will give you a good understanding of how to relax before programming your SCM with your desired results.

"What is your Pentagon of Strength ranking?"



Limit – Speed – Anaerobic – Aerobic – Mental

Ask yourself, or your team to rate themselves on a scale of 1 to 10 for each of the five pillars of the Pentagon of Strength.

"Whether you think you can or think you can't,
you're probably right."
—Henry Ford

1. You must label the answer yourself.
2. The first answer is usually the correct one. It usually comes out within 20 seconds.
3. The subconscious will bring out the right answer, once it is asked.
4. These answers, and any tests you may do (weightlifting, wind sprints, 1-mile run, medicine ball, etc.) will give you the foundation to work from.
5. Apply your training methods (a combination between mental and physical training) to increase your self-concept and physical actions.

If you would like us to take a look at your answers, email them to Win@TeamMastermind.com. Write your numerical answers here:

- a. Limit Strength _____
- b. Speed Strength _____
- c. Anaerobic Strength _____
- d. Aerobic Strength _____
- e. Mental Strength _____

Nine steps to an unstoppable attitude



1. Decide to have a positive state-of-mind. This will literally change the chemical make-up of your brain.
2. Understand that **every** thought is instructing the subconscious in one way or another – positive or negative.
3. Monitor your thoughts for 24 hours. *How* do you think? Predominately positive or mostly negative?
4. For 24 hours decide to find the positive in every situation. Speak only positive statements. You'll find that the world is a literal cesspool of negative garbage.
5. Affirm to yourself five positive, present tense statements such as:
 - "I am determined yet flexible!"
 - "I know what is required in my sport and I am applying my knowledge successfully!"
 - "I am confident in every situation!"
 - I strongly attract success, opportunity, and victory!"
 - "Confidence and assurance of success fill my mind and thoughts!"

Do this once before bed and once in the morning. Make these affirmations a habit. Picture the corresponding affirmation as vividly as you can. See yourself acting confident and in control. How do you feel? Make this feeling a habit. Remember anything you do 21 times creates a habit.

6. Develop your weapon. Perfect one aspect of your game that you love. Become the best at it, something only you can do. Make this a priority.
 - Greg Rusedski has the fastest serve in tennis.
 - John Elway perfected the 2-minute drill in football.
 - Sheldon Kannegiesser was the fastest backward skater in the NHL.
 - Andre Agassi has the best return-of-serve in the game of tennis.
 - *What can you become the best at? What do you love to do within your sport?*

- What can you create a very high self-concept for in your sport, i.e., the kick in the last 10 yards of a 100-meter sprint, extreme persistence in the last two minutes, or chasing down every last ball with bulldog tenacity?



7. Strengthen your weaknesses. Develop a well-rounded game in your sport. Do not have any weaknesses that an opponent feels confident to attack. When you have no weakness, and feel as though you can attack from any area, this can help you keep your opponent in his/her comfort zone.

8. Look confident. Act confident. Act as if it were impossible to fail.

9. Imagine the TV show "60 Minutes" was doing an expose on the life of a professional athlete. They were to follow you around for 7 days. What would they write about? Would you be a confident, disciplined champion, or a quivering, whining loser? How would you act in every scenario?

Law of Substitution – The Mind of a Winner

When a negative arises that could cause you to lose focus, take these two steps immediately:

You can go through all of this in your mind. Please use your good judgment and common sense. It is not always appropriate to yell 'Cancel!' in your classroom, on the field, or during work.

It can be just as effective if you tell your mind with intensity to cancel a thought while simply thinking in your mind. But you must remember, the more emotions that are involved the better your mind will negate the negative thought.

1. 'Cancel!' the thought immediately. Do not let it grow into a mental movie.
2. Immediately replace the thought with one of your well thought-out affirmations that are on your goal card.

Laws for Athletic Success

The Law of Cause and Effect – For every cause, there is an effect. There is no luck and there are no accidents. For everything that you do (cause), you produce a result (effect).

The Law of Mind – You become what you think about. If you worry about performing badly, you will perform badly. If you focus on performing well, you will perform well.

The Conscious Mind – The portion of the mind that accounts for about 10 percent of your total mind. The conscious is known as the logical or thinking mind. This part of the mind controls the thoughts you hold and dwell on. The conscious mind can hold only one thought at a time.

The Subconscious Mind (SCM)– Tapping into your sub-conscious mind is your master key to athletic success. The sub-conscious accounts for about 90 percent of the total mind. This is the storehouse for every conscious thought, vision, action, re-action, and experience that you have ever had.

Law of Affirmation – Your conscious mind commands your subconscious mind by holding thoughts. The thoughts you hold with extreme repetition are normally accepted by the subconscious mind. Your subconscious does exactly what it is told to do by looking at what your conscious mind is dwelling upon most often.

- It is a single statement,
- It is stated in the positive,
- It is in the present tense, such as;

“I am the greatest!” –Muhammad Ali

“I feel light on my feet.” –Nick Bollettieri

The Slight-Edge Principle – You will experience rapid success if you practice simple daily disciplines that are consistent with your goals.

Law of Visualization – Whatever you picture in your mind with clarity and repetition will instruct the subconscious mind to act to fulfill the visualization.

Law of Input – You can take control of your thoughts by first taking control of the things that you allow to enter your mind.

Law of Substitution – This law says that you can simply substitute a positive thought for a negative thought.

Crisis of Consciousness – All negative happenings can be labeled as a crisis to varying degrees. All crises are nothing more than a crisis of the way you think.

Law of Habit – Everything we do is automatic. We have habits that have been ingrained in us since we were born. If it weren't for habits, our time would be occupied by consciously thinking about how to walk, run, and jump. Habits free us from having to re-learn the basic skills that we rely on daily, every time we set foot on the playing field.

The Law of 21 – If you do anything 21 times repeatedly, without interrupting the process by doing the individual movement another way, you have laid in the foundation for a habit.

The Law of Self-concept – Your self-concept is a set of beliefs and principles that you believe to be true for yourself. These beliefs are formulated by your conscious mind and secured in place in your subconscious mind. You put those beliefs there, and now every thing you do is first regulated by your self-concept to see if it's consistent with your beliefs.

Law of the Comfort Zone – A window of performance that extends from the top of the self-concept to anywhere below the self-concept. Some examples were given in the manual that said it is in a window 10% below your self-concept. This is only for example as your comfort zone can be anywhere below your peak performance.

The Peak Performance Zone – A window of performance that extends from the top of the self-concept to 10% above the self-concept.

Good Habit – Any habit that is consistent with your highest priority goals.

Bad Habit – Any habit that is pulling you away from your highest priority goals.